

1. Distributional Properties of Categorical Processes

1.1. General Notation

Let (X_t) be a *categorical* time series process, where each X_t takes values in

$$S := \{s_0, \dots, s_m\}, \quad m \in \mathbb{N}.$$

(X_t) may be *nominal*, in which case the order of magnitude of the elements in S is arbitrary and solely used for notational consistency, or *ordinal*, in which case the order of the elements in S reflects the inherent order of the elements.

1.2. Stationarity

Furthermore, (X_t) is assumed to be stationary. A distinction can be made between two forms of stationarity:

Definition 1.1 (Weak Stationarity). A process (X_t) is said to be *weakly stationary* if:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}(X_t) &= \mu_X & \forall t, \\ \mathbb{E}(X_t^2) &< \infty & \forall t, \\ \text{Cov}(X_t, X_{t+h}) &= \gamma(h) & \forall t, h. \end{aligned}$$

Definition 1.2 (Strong/ Strict Stationarity). Strong/ Strict stationarity requires that all finite-dimensional distributions are invariant under time shifts, i.e.,

$$F_{X_t, \dots, X_{t+j}} = F_{X_{t+h}, \dots, X_{t+h+j}} \quad \forall t, j, h. \quad (1.1)$$

1.3. Marginal Distributions

Regardless of whether we consider a simple categorical process with few categories or attempt to describe a complex, temporally evolving process using moments and measures of serial dependence, the analysis of categorical processes is always built on the examination of the marginal probabilities. However, because ordinal and nominal data encode different types of information, their marginals are typically represented in different ways:

- **Ordinal data:** Most analytical tools for ordinal processes take into account the natural ordering of the elements in S . For this reason, most methods for ordinal data rely on the marginal cumulative distribution function (CDF), which accumulates probabilities in accordance with the natural ordering of the categories:

$$\mathbf{f} = (f_0, \dots, f_{m-1})^\top, \quad f_i := P(X_t \leq s_i).$$

For ordinal data, it is sufficient to consider the cumulative probabilities of the categories $0, \dots, m-1$ since the cumulative probability of the last category m is always equal to 1.

Although one could equivalently estimate the PMF and derive the CDF from it, representing ordinal data through the CDF is often more convenient as it this form that is used to compute metrics for location and dispersion.

- **Nominal data:** Since the categories of nominal variables do not possess a meaningful order, statistical procedures cannot make use of cumulative structure. Therefore the marginal distribution is best represented by the probability mass function (PMF):

$$\mathbf{p} = (p_0, \dots, p_m)^\top, \quad p_i := P(X_t = s_i).$$

1.4. Bivariate Probabilities at Lag h

Definition 1.3 (Bivariate lag- h probabilities). Let (X_t) be a stationary categorical time series. The bivariate lag- h probabilities are defined as follows.

- (i) **Ordinal series:**

$$f_{ij}(h) := P(X_t \leq s_i, X_{t+h} \leq s_j), \quad i, j = 0, \dots, m-1.$$

- (ii) **Nominal series:**

$$p_{ij}(h) := P(X_t = s_i, X_{t+h} = s_j), \quad i, j = 0, \dots, m.$$

Under serial independence, the bivariate probabilities factorize as $f_{ij}(h) = f_i f_j$ and $p_{ij}(h) = p_i p_j$ respectively.

1.5. Location

For a nominal process, any measure that relies on ordering is inappropriate. Instead, a location measure must depend only on the category probabilities. The mode, defined as the most probable category,

$$\text{Mod}(X_t) = \arg \max_{s_i \in S} P(X_t = s_i),$$

is therefore the natural choice. It provides a meaningful summary of the process by identifying the most frequent category.

For an ordinal process, the natural ordering of the categories allows for additional measures of central tendency. While the mode can still be informative as the most frequent category, the median respects the ordering of categories and is often more useful for describing the central location:

$$\text{Med}(X_t) = \min\left\{s_i \in S : F(s_i) \geq \frac{1}{2}\right\}.$$

Thus, for ordinal data, both the mode and the median carry information, but they capture slightly different aspects of location: the mode identifies the most typical category, whereas the median indicates the midpoint in the ordered scale.

1.6. Measures of Dispersion

Since the concept of dispersion differs between ordinal and nominal processes, two separate measures are employed: the *Index of Ordinal Variation* (IOV) for ordinal data and the *Index of Qualitative Variation* (IQV) for nominal data, defined as

$$\text{IOV}(\mathbf{f}) = \frac{4}{m} \sum_{i=0}^{m-1} f_i(1 - f_i), \quad \text{IQV}(\mathbf{p}) = \frac{m+1}{m} \left(1 - \sum_{i=0}^m p_i^2\right). \quad (1.2)$$

Both indices are scaled to $[0, 1]$, with 0 indicating a degenerate (one-point) distribution and 1 indicating maximal dispersion. However, what constitutes maximal dispersion differs: for ordinal data, dispersion is maximal when all probability mass is concentrated in the two outermost categories, whereas for nominal data it corresponds to the uniform distribution over all $m + 1$ categories.

Proposition 1.4 (Dispersion Bounds). *Both IOV and IQV satisfy:*

- (i) $\text{IOV} = 0$ (resp. $\text{IQV} = 0$) if and only if the distribution is degenerate.
- (ii) $\text{IOV} = 1$ iff $\mathbf{f} = (\frac{1}{2}, \dots, \frac{1}{2})^\top$; $\text{IQV} = 1$ iff $p_i = \frac{1}{m+1}$ for all i .

Proof. Part (i), ordinal case. A one-point distribution assigns all probability mass to a single category $s_j \in S$. For ordinal data, this corresponds to a CDF vector $\mathbf{f}$ of the form

$$\mathbf{f} \in \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ \vdots \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ \vdots \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \dots, \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \right\} := \{\mathbf{c}_0, \dots, \mathbf{c}_m\} \subset [0, 1]^{m+1}.$$

In each of these cases, every component f_i satisfies $f_i \in \{0, 1\}$, and thus

$$f_i(1 - f_i) = 0 \quad \forall i.$$

Therefore,

$$\text{IOV} = \frac{4}{m} \sum_{i=0}^{m-1} f_i(1 - f_i) = 0.$$

Conversely, if $\text{IOV} = 0$, then

$$\sum_{i=0}^{m-1} f_i(1 - f_i) = 0,$$

and since each term is nonnegative,

$$f_i(1 - f_i) \stackrel{!}{=} 0 \quad \forall i.$$

This is only possible if $f_i \in \{0, 1\}$ for all i , which implies $\mathbf{f} \in \{\mathbf{e}_0, \dots, \mathbf{e}_m\}$. Hence, $\text{IOV} = 0$ holds *exactly* for a degenerate one-point distribution.

Part (i), nominal case. A degenerate (one-point) distribution assigns all probability mass to a single category $s_j \in S$, which corresponds to a PMF vector of the form

$$\mathbf{p} \in \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}, \dots, \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \right\} := \{\mathbf{e}_0, \dots, \mathbf{e}_m\} \subset [0, 1]^{m+1}.$$

In each of these cases, exactly one component equals 1 and all others equal 0, so

$$\sum_{i=0}^m p_i^2 = 1.$$

Thus,

$$\text{IQV} = \frac{m+1}{m} \left(1 - \sum_{i=0}^m p_i^2 \right) = \frac{m+1}{m} (1 - 1) = 0.$$

Conversely, if $\text{IQV} = 0$, then

$$\frac{m+1}{m} \left(1 - \sum_{i=0}^m p_i^2 \right) = 0 \implies \sum_{i=0}^m p_i^2 = 1.$$

As all probabilities satisfy $0 \leq p_i \leq 1$, it follows that

$$p_i^2 \leq p_i \quad \forall p_i, \text{ and } p_i^2 < p_i \quad \forall p_i \notin \{0, 1\}.$$

Since $\sum_{i=1}^m p_i = 1$, it follows that the only way $\sum_i p_i^2 = 1$ can hold is if exactly one p_i equals 1 and all others are 0. In other words, the distribution is degenerate and $\mathbf{p} \in \{\mathbf{e}_0, \dots, \mathbf{e}_m\}$.

Part (ii), ordinal case. Dispersion of an ordinal variable is maximal when half of the probability mass lies in the lowest category and half in the highest category; with all intermediate categories having probability zero. This results in a CDF vector,

$$\mathbf{f} = \left(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2}, \dots, \frac{1}{2} \right)^\top.$$

Then

$$f_i(1 - f_i) = \frac{1}{2} \left(1 - \frac{1}{2}\right) = \frac{1}{4} \quad \forall i,$$

and thus

$$\text{IOV} = \frac{4}{m} \cdot \sum_{i=0}^{m-1} \frac{1}{4} = \frac{4}{m} \cdot \frac{m}{4} = 1.$$

To show that $\text{IOV} = 1 \Rightarrow \mathbf{f} = (\frac{1}{2}, \dots, \frac{1}{2})^T$, recall that the IOV only depends on $\mathbf{f}$ through the sum

$$\sum_{i=0}^{m-1} f_i(1 - f_i).$$

Taking the derivative of $g(f_i) := f_i(1 - f_i)$ and setting it to zero yields:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial}{\partial f_i} g(f_i) &= 1 - 2f_i, \\ 1 - 2f_i &\stackrel{!}{=} 0, \\ f_i &= \frac{1}{2}. \end{aligned}$$

Since $g(f_i = 0) = g(f_i = 1) = 0$, the function is concave and this critical point is indeed the global maximum. Since it has been already shown that $\text{IOV}(\mathbf{f} = (\frac{1}{2}, \dots, \frac{1}{2})^T) = 1$, it directly follows that

$$\text{IOV}(\mathbf{f}) = 1 \Leftrightarrow \mathbf{f} = \left(\frac{1}{2}, \dots, \frac{1}{2}\right)^\top$$

Part (ii), nominal case. For nominal data, maximal dispersion is attained when probability mass is distributed uniformly across all $m + 1$ categories, i.e.

$$p_i = \frac{1}{m + 1}, \quad i = 0, \dots, m.$$

In this case,

$$\sum_{i=0}^m p_i^2 = (m + 1) \frac{1}{(m + 1)^2} = \frac{1}{m + 1},$$

and hence

$$\text{IQV} = \frac{m + 1}{m} \left(1 - \frac{1}{m + 1}\right) = 1.$$

Conversely, suppose that $\text{IQV} = 1$. Then

$$\frac{m + 1}{m} \left(1 - \sum_{i=0}^m p_i^2\right) = 1 \quad \Rightarrow \quad \sum_{i=0}^m p_i^2 = \frac{1}{m + 1}.$$

Thus, maximizing IQV is equivalent to minimizing

$$f(\mathbf{p}) := \sum_{i=0}^m p_i^2 \quad \text{subject to} \quad \sum_{i=0}^m p_i = 1.$$

Introducing the Lagrangian (with Lagrange multiplier λ)

$$\mathcal{L}(\mathbf{p}, \lambda) := \sum_{i=0}^m p_i^2 - \lambda \left(\sum_{i=0}^m p_i - 1 \right),$$

the first-order conditions are

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial p_j} &= 2p_j - \lambda = 0 \\ \Rightarrow \quad 2p_j &= \lambda, \quad j = 0, \dots, m, \end{aligned}$$

together with the constraint $\sum_{i=0}^m p_i = 1$. Since the same multiplier λ applies to all components, it follows that

$$p_0 = p_1 = \dots = p_m.$$

Imposing the constraint yields

$$(m+1)p_j = 1 \quad \Rightarrow \quad p_j = \frac{1}{m+1} \quad \forall j \in 0, \dots, m.$$

Hence, $f(\mathbf{p})$ is uniquely minimized at

$$\mathbf{p} = \left(\frac{1}{m+1}, \dots, \frac{1}{m+1} \right)^\top,$$

and therefore IQV attains its maximal value at the uniform distribution. □

1.7. Measures of serial dependence

The marginal distribution of a categorical time series captures the long-run frequencies of the individual categories, but contains no information about the temporal structure of the process. To describe how the process evolves over time, measures of serial dependence are required.

For real-valued processes, the autocorrelation function (ACF) is the standard tool for quantifying temporal dependence (Brockwell and Davis, 2016, see Section 1.4). However, the ACF is not directly applicable to categorical data, since it relies on the existence of meaningful arithmetic operations on the observed values. For nominal data, such operations are undefined, and for ordinal data they are questionable, as the categories carry no numerical meaning beyond their ordering.

Dependence measures for categorical time series are typically constructed from the bivariate lag- h probabilities introduced in definition 1.3. Under serial independence, these would factorize as $f_{ij}(h) = f_i f_j$ and $p_{ij}(h) = p_i p_j$ respectively. Measures for serial dependence are naturally constructed by quantifying the deviation of the bivariate probabilities from this independence benchmark.

Natural and widely used measures of serial dependence are the ordinal and nominal versions of Cohen's κ (WeiSS, 2018, p. 130), which compare the joint probabilities to those expected under independence. For lag h , they are defined as

Definition 1.5 (Cohen's κ).

$$\kappa_{\text{ord}}(h) = \frac{\sum_{j=0}^{m-1} (f_{jj}(h) - f_j^2)}{\sum_{i=0}^{m-1} f_i(1 - f_i)} \quad \text{and} \quad \kappa_{\text{nom}}(h) = \frac{\sum_{j=0}^m (p_{jj}(h) - p_j^2)}{1 - \sum_{i=0}^m p_i^2}.$$

The numerator of each measure sums the diagonal deviations $f_{jj}(h) - f_j^2$ (resp. $p_{jj}(h) - p_j^2$), which capture the excess probability of observing the same category at times t and $t + h$ relative to what would be expected under independence. The denominator normalizes the numerator by a measure of marginal dispersion: for the ordinal version it equals $\frac{m}{4} \cdot \text{IOV}$, and for the nominal version it is equal to $\frac{m}{m+1} \cdot \text{IQV}$. This ensures that $\kappa(h)$ is invariant to the overall level of dispersion in the marginal distribution. For both measures, positive values indicate that the process tends to remain in the same category across lag h , while negative values indicate a tendency to switch categories.

Under perfect positive dependence, i.e. $P(X_{t+h} = s_i \mid X_t = s_i) = 1$ for all $s_i \in S$, we have $f_{jj}(h) = f_j$ and $p_{jj}(h) = p_j$, and both measures attain their upper bound:

$$\begin{aligned} \kappa_{\text{ord}}(h) &= \frac{\sum_{j=0}^{m-1} (f_j - f_j^2)}{\sum_{i=0}^{m-1} (f_i - f_i^2)} = 1, \\ \kappa_{\text{nom}}(h) &= \frac{\sum_{j=0}^m (p_j - p_j^2)}{1 - \sum_{i=0}^m p_i^2} = \frac{1 - \sum_{j=0}^m p_j^2}{1 - \sum_{i=0}^m p_i^2} = 1. \end{aligned}$$

where we used that $\sum_{j=0}^m p_j = 1$, so that $\sum_{j=0}^m (p_j - p_j^2) = 1 - \sum_{j=0}^m p_j^2$. Under serial independence, $f_{jj}(h) = f_j^2$ and $p_{jj}(h) = p_j p_j$, so that the numerator vanishes and $\kappa(h) = 0$.

For the nominal version, the lower bound is attained when $p_{jj}(h) = 0$ for all j , i.e. when the process never remains in the same category across lag h :

$$\kappa_{\text{nom}}(h) = \frac{-\sum_{j=0}^m p_j^2}{1 - \sum_{i=0}^m p_i^2},$$

which depends on the marginal distribution and equals -1 only in the special case of a uniform marginal. For the ordinal version, the lower bound takes an analogous form but involves the cumulative probabilities f_j .

2. Samples Measures

2.1. Estimation of Marginal Distributions

To estimate the marginal (cumulative) probabilities, we express the relative frequencies through a binarization of the original process (X_t) . For ordinal data, define the indicator vector

$$\mathbf{Z}_t := (Z_{t,0}, \dots, Z_{t,m-1})^\top, \quad Z_{t,i} := \mathbb{I}\{X_t \leq s_i\},$$

and for nominal data analogously

$$\mathbf{Y}_t := (Y_{t,0}, \dots, Y_{t,m})^\top, \quad Y_{t,i} := \mathbb{I}\{X_t = s_i\}.$$

Here, $\mathbb{I}\{A\}$ denotes the indicator function, which equals 1 if the event A is true and 0 otherwise. The marginal CDF and PMF vectors are estimated by the corresponding sample means:

Definition 2.1 (Empirical CDF and PMF estimators).

$$\hat{\mathbf{f}} := \frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^n \mathbf{Z}_t, \quad \hat{\mathbf{p}} := \frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^n \mathbf{Y}_t.$$

2.2. Asymptotics of the marginal estimator

To derive the asymptotic distribution of $\hat{\mathbf{f}}$ and $\hat{\mathbf{p}}$, a central limit theorem for dependent data is required. Since independence is not assumed, we impose weak dependence conditions on the original process (X_t) .

Specifically, $(X_t)_{t \in \mathbb{Z}}$ is assumed to be strictly stationary (recall Definition 1.2) and α -mixing with exponentially decaying coefficients.

Definition 2.2 (α -Mixing with Exponential Decay). Following Bradley (2005, Section 1.2.), let

$$\mathcal{F}_J^L := \sigma(X_t : J \leq t \leq L)$$

denote the σ -field generated by $\{X_t : J \leq t \leq L\}$. The α -mixing coefficients of (X_t) , given that it's strictly stationary, are defined as

$$\alpha_{X_t}(n) := \sup_{A \in \mathcal{F}_{-\infty}^0, B \in \mathcal{F}_n^\infty} |P(A \cap B) - P(A)P(B)|.$$

The process is called α -mixing if $\alpha(n) \rightarrow 0$ as $n \rightarrow \infty$.

We additionally assume exponential decay of the mixing coefficients, i.e., there exist constants $C > 0$ and $\rho \in (0, 1)$ such that

$$\alpha(n) \leq C\rho^n \quad \text{for all } n \in \mathbb{N}. \quad (2.1)$$

The indicator mappings

$$g_i(X_t) := \mathbb{I}\{X_t \leq s_i\}, \quad h_i(X_t) := \mathbb{I}\{X_t = s_i\},$$

are measurable functions of X_t (Klenke, 2005, p. 36). Since measurability preserves strict stationarity, the binarized processes $(g_i(X_t))$ and $(h_i(X_t))$ are strictly stationary whenever (X_t) is strictly stationary (Kallenberg, 2021, p. 157). Consequently, the vector-valued processes $\mathbf{Z}_t$ and $\mathbf{Y}_t$ are strictly stationary as well.

Moreover, each indicator variable $Z_{t,i}$ is defined on the same probability space as X_t , and the σ -field it generates satisfies

$$\sigma(Z_{t,i} : J \leq t \leq L) \subset \sigma(X_t : J \leq t \leq L), \quad J \leq L,$$

which implies $\alpha_{Z_{t,i}}(n) \leq \alpha_{X_t}(n)$ for all i and n . Hence, $\mathbf{Z}_t$ and $\mathbf{Y}_t$ are also α -mixing with exponentially decaying coefficients.

To derive the asymptotic distribution of $\hat{\mathbf{f}}$, we apply the CramérWold theorem (Kallenberg, 2021, Corollary 4.5). Specifically, $\hat{\mathbf{f}}$ converges in distribution to a multivariate normal vector if and only if the univariate central limit theorem holds for all linear combinations of $\mathbf{Z}_t$ with nonzero coefficients, that is,

$$U_t := \mathbf{a}^\top \mathbf{Z}_t, \quad \mathbf{a} \in \mathbb{R}^m \setminus \{\mathbf{0}\}.$$

To see that U_t is measurable, let

$$L : \mathbb{R}^{m+1} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}, \quad L(\mathbf{z}) = \mathbf{a}^\top \mathbf{z}.$$

Since L is linear on a finite-dimensional space, it is continuous and hence Borel-measurable (Klenke, 2005, Theorem 1.88). The measurability of $g(X_t) = \mathbf{Z}_t$ follows from the measurability of its components, and the composition $U_t = L \circ g \circ X_t$ is measurable by Klenke (2005, Theorem 1.80). Hence U_t inherits strict stationarity and α -mixing with $\alpha_{U_t}(n) \leq \alpha_{X_t}(n) \leq C\rho^n$ from (X_t) . We apply the CLT of Ibragimov (1962, Theorem 7), which requires four conditions:

- (i) **Strict stationarity.** Verified above, as U_t is a measurable function of the strictly stationary process (X_t) .
- (ii) **α -mixing.** Verified above, with $\alpha_{U_t}(n) \leq C\rho^n$.
- (iii) **Summability.** The mixing coefficients are required to satisfy

$$\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \alpha(n)^{\lambda/(2+\lambda)} < \infty \quad \text{for some } \lambda > 0.$$

Under exponential decay $\alpha(n) \leq C\rho^n$, this follows from

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \alpha(n)^{\lambda/(2+\lambda)} &\leq C^{\lambda/(2+\lambda)} \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \rho^{n\lambda/(2+\lambda)} \\ &= C^{\lambda/(2+\lambda)} \frac{\rho^{\lambda/(2+\lambda)}}{1 - \rho^{\lambda/(2+\lambda)}} < \infty, \end{aligned}$$

since $0 < \rho^{\lambda/(2+\lambda)} < 1$ for all $\lambda > 0$.

- (iv) **Moment condition.** The theorem requires $E|U_t|^{2+\lambda} < \infty$ for some $\lambda > 0$. Since each $Z_{t,i} \in \{0, 1\}$, the projection U_t is bounded by $M := \sum_{i=0}^{m-1} |a_i| < \infty$, and hence $E|U_t|^{2+\lambda} \leq M^{2+\lambda} < \infty$ for all $\lambda > 0$.

All four conditions being satisfied, Ibragimov's CLT applies to (U_t) , and by the Cramér–Wold device, the asymptotic variance matrix $\Sigma_Z = (\sigma_{Z;i,j})$ is determined by

$$\mathbf{a}^\top \Sigma_Z \mathbf{a} = \text{Var}(U_t) + 2 \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \text{Cov}(U_t, U_{t+h}),$$

which gives

$$\sigma_{Z;i,j} = \text{Cov}(Z_{t,i}, Z_{t,j}) + \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} [\text{Cov}(Z_{t,i}, Z_{t+h,j}) + \text{Cov}(Z_{t,j}, Z_{t+h,i})].$$

Using $\text{Cov}(Z_{t,i}, Z_{t,j}) = f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j$ and $\text{Cov}(Z_{t,i}, Z_{t+h,j}) = f_{ij}(h) - f_i f_j$, the elements of Σ_Z take the explicit form

$$\sigma_{Z;i,j} = (f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) + \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} (f_{ij}(h) + f_{ji}(h) - 2f_i f_j).$$

Theorem 2.3 (Asymptotic Normality of $\hat{\mathbf{f}}$). *Let (X_t) be strictly stationary and α -mixing with exponentially decaying coefficients. Then*

$$\sqrt{n}(\hat{\mathbf{f}} - \mathbf{f}) \xrightarrow[n \rightarrow \infty]{d} \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{0}, \Sigma_Z),$$

where $\Sigma_Z = (\sigma_{Z;i,j})_{i,j=0,\dots,m-1}$ is given by

$$\sigma_{Z;i,j} = (f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) + \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} (f_{ij}(h) + f_{ji}(h) - 2f_i f_j). \quad (2.2)$$

2.3. Asymptotic Properties of Sample Dispersion Measures

IOV

We can now use this information of the asymptotic distribution of $\hat{\mathbf{f}}$ to compute the asymptotic properties of sample measures that are based on $\hat{\mathbf{f}}$. According to the

multivariate delta method (van der Vaart, 1998, Chapter 3) a random variable $G^* := g^*(\Theta^*)$, where $\Theta^* \in \mathbb{R}^m$, $\sqrt{n}(\Theta^* - \Theta) \stackrel{asy.}{\sim} \mathcal{N}(0, \Sigma^*)$ and $g^* : \mathbb{R}^m \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is a continuously differentiable function, satisfies

$$\sqrt{n}(G^* - g^*(\Theta)) \stackrel{asy.}{\sim} \mathcal{N}(0, \mathbf{j}\Sigma^*\mathbf{j}^\top)$$

where $\mathbf{j}$ is the Jacobian and where $j_i = \frac{\partial g^*(\Theta)}{\partial \theta_i}$.

Since we have shown that $\hat{\mathbf{f}}$ is asymptotically normal we can use this to derive the asymptotic properties of sample measures like the IOV. The respective Jacobian is given by:

$$\mathbf{j}_{\text{IOV}} = \left(\frac{\partial \text{IOV}(\mathbf{f})}{\partial f_0}, \dots, \frac{\partial \text{IOV}(\mathbf{f})}{\partial f_{m-1}} \right) = \frac{4}{m} ((1 - 2f_0), \dots, (1 - 2f_{m-1}))$$

which leads to an asymptotic variance of the IOV:

$$\begin{aligned} \sqrt{n}\text{Var}(\widehat{\text{IOV}}(\mathbf{f})) &\stackrel{asy.}{=} \mathbf{j}_{\text{IOV}} \Sigma_Z \mathbf{j}_{\text{IOV}}^\top = \sum_{i,j=0}^{m-1} \frac{4(1-2f_i)}{m} \frac{4(1-2f_j)}{m} \sigma_{Z;i,j} \\ &= \frac{16}{m^2} \sum_{i,j=0}^{m-1} (1-2f_i)(1-2f_j) \sigma_{Z;i,j} \end{aligned}$$

However, since IOV is not a linear function, the first-order delta method only provides information about the asymptotic distribution and variance, not on the finite-sample bias:

$$(\widehat{\text{IOV}} \xrightarrow{p} \text{IOV}(\mathbf{f})) \not\Rightarrow (\mathbb{E}[\widehat{\text{IOV}}] = \text{IOV}(\mathbf{f})).$$

For nonlinear transformations, the curvature induces a bias of order n^{-1} . Since $\text{IOV}(\mathbf{f}) = \frac{4}{m} \sum_{i=0}^{m-1} f_i(1-f_i)$ is quadratic in $\mathbf{f}$, all derivatives of order three and higher are equal to 0. Consequently, the second-order Taylor expansion is not merely an approximation but exact:

$$\text{IOV}(\hat{\mathbf{f}}) = \text{IOV}(\mathbf{f}) + \mathbf{j}_{\text{IOV}}(\hat{\mathbf{f}} - \mathbf{f}) + \frac{1}{2}(\hat{\mathbf{f}} - \mathbf{f})^\top \mathbf{H}_{\text{IOV}}(\mathbf{f})(\hat{\mathbf{f}} - \mathbf{f}),$$

with no remainder term. $\mathbf{H}_{\text{IOV}}(\mathbf{f})$ is the Hessian matrix such that

$$\mathbf{H}_{\text{IOV}}(\mathbf{f}) = \left(\frac{\partial^2 \text{IOV}(\mathbf{f})}{\partial f_i \partial f_j} \right)_{i,j=0,\dots,m-1} = \begin{cases} -\frac{8}{m} & \text{if } i = j \\ 0 & \text{else} \end{cases} = -\frac{8}{m} \mathbf{I}_m.$$

To take the expectation of the quadratic term, we use the following lemma:

Lemma 2.4. Let $\mathbf{u} \in \mathbb{R}^m$ be a random vector with $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{u}] = \mathbf{0}$ and let $\mathbf{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times m}$ be deterministic. Then

$$\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{A} \mathbf{u}] = \text{tr}(\mathbf{A} \text{Cov}(\mathbf{u})).$$

Proof. Since $\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{A} \mathbf{u}$ is a scalar, it follows from the cyclic property of the trace (Banerjee and Roy, 2014, Theorem 1.5) that $\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{A} \mathbf{u} = \text{tr}(\mathbf{A} \mathbf{u} \mathbf{u}^\top)$. Because expectation and trace are both linear and $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{u}] = \mathbf{0}$, it follows that

$$\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{A} \mathbf{u}] = \text{tr}(\mathbf{A} \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{u} \mathbf{u}^\top]) = \text{tr}(\mathbf{A} \text{Cov}(\mathbf{u})). \quad \square$$

Since $E(\mathbf{j}_{\text{IOV}}(\hat{\mathbf{f}} - \mathbf{f})) = 0$, the finite-sample bias is given by

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Bias}(\text{IOV}(\hat{\mathbf{f}})) &= E\left[\frac{1}{2}(\hat{\mathbf{f}} - \mathbf{f})^\top \mathbf{H}_{\text{IOV}}(\mathbf{f})(\hat{\mathbf{f}} - \mathbf{f})\right] \quad (\text{Lemma 2.4}) \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \text{tr}(\mathbf{H}_{\text{IOV}} \text{Cov}(\hat{\mathbf{f}})) \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \text{tr}\left(-\frac{8}{m} \mathbf{I}_m \cdot \frac{1}{n} \Sigma_Z\right) \\ &= -\frac{4}{mn} \sum_{i=0}^{m-1} \sigma_{Z;i,i}. \end{aligned}$$

This implies that the bias is strictly negative and only depends on the marginal variances $\sigma_{Z;i,i}$ of the individual estimators f_i , not on the covariances. The results are summarized in the following theorem:

Theorem 2.5 (Asymptotic Distribution of $\widehat{\text{IOV}}$). *Under the assumptions of Theorem 2.3:*

(i) **Asymptotic variance:**

$$\sqrt{n} \text{Var}(\widehat{\text{IOV}}) \stackrel{\text{asy.}}{=} \frac{16}{m^2} \sum_{i,j=0}^{m-1} (1 - 2f_i)(1 - 2f_j) \sigma_{Z;i,j}. \quad (2.3)$$

(ii) **Bias to order n^{-1} :**

$$\text{Bias}(\widehat{\text{IOV}}) = -\frac{4}{m n} \sum_{i=0}^{m-1} \sigma_{Z;i,i}. \quad (2.4)$$

Skewness

In a similar way the asymptotic properties of other dispersion metrics such as the skew can be analyzed. A simple measure for the skew of an ordinal process is given by:

$$\text{skew}(\mathbf{f}) = \frac{2}{m} \left(\sum_{i=0}^{m-1} f_i \right) - 1.$$

This measure captures asymmetry through the average level of the CDF. A symmetric distribution is taken as a baseline, and deviations from this baseline reflect asymmetry in the distribution. The measure is scaled to $[-1, 1]$. For a more detailed discussion of skewness measures for ordinal data, see Klein and Doll (2021). The three extreme cases illustrate its behavior clearly:

- **Left-skewed** (skew = 1): all probability mass is concentrated in the lowest category s_0 , so $f_i = 1$ for all i and skew = $\frac{2}{m} \cdot m - 1 = 1$.

- **Symmetric** (skew = 0): the distribution is symmetric around the midpoint, which implies $f_i + f_{m-1-i} = 1$ for all i . It follows that $\sum_{i=0}^{m-1} f_i = m/2$ and skew = $\frac{2}{m} \cdot \frac{m}{2} - 1 = 0$.
- **Right-skewed** (skew = -1): all probability mass is concentrated in the highest category s_m , so $f_i = 0$ for all $i < m$ and skew = $\frac{2}{m} \cdot 0 - 1 = -1$.

The Jacobian for the skew is given by

$$\mathbf{j}_{skew} = \left(\frac{\partial \text{skew}(\mathbf{f})}{\partial f_0}, \dots, \frac{\partial \text{skew}(\mathbf{f})}{\partial f_{m-1}} \right) = \left(\frac{2}{m}, \dots, \frac{2}{m} \right)$$

such that we end up with the following results:

Proposition 2.6 (Asymptotic Properties of $\widehat{\text{skew}}$). *Under the assumptions of Theorem 2.3:*

$$\sqrt{n} \text{Var}(\widehat{\text{skew}}) \stackrel{asy.}{=} \frac{4}{m^2} \sum_{i,j=0}^{m-1} \sigma_{Z;ij}. \quad (2.5)$$

Since skew is linear in $\mathbf{f}$, the Hessian vanishes and the estimator is exactly unbiased for all n .

3. Introducing Missingness

3.1. Missingness Mechanisms

In many applied settings, categorical time series are not fully observed. Individual time points may be missing due to sensor failures, non-response in survey data, or dropout in longitudinal studies. Before modelling the statistical consequences of missingness, it is useful to distinguish between different mechanisms that may give rise to it, as these have fundamentally different implications for estimation.

The classical taxonomy of missing data mechanisms goes back to Rubin (1976), who distinguished between three types based on the dependence structure between the missingness and the underlying data. While Rubin’s framework was originally developed for multivariate cross-sectional data, the core concepts translate naturally to the time series setting when conditioning is extended to the full history of the process. Denoting by $O_t \in \{0, 1\}$ the indicator of whether X_t is observed (to be formally introduced in Section 3.2), and by $\mathcal{F}_{t-1} := \sigma(X_s, O_s : s < t)$ the history up to time t , the three mechanisms are defined as follows.

Definition 3.1 (Missingness Mechanisms). [(i)]

1. **Missing Completely at Random (MCAR):** The observation probability does not depend on the current or past values of the process:

$$P(O_t = 1 \mid X_t, \mathcal{F}_{t-1}) = \pi.$$

2. **Missing at Random (MAR):** The observation probability depends on the observed history, but not on the current (possibly unobserved) value:

$$P(O_t = 1 \mid X_t, \mathcal{F}_{t-1}) = P(O_t = 1 \mid \mathcal{F}_{t-1}).$$

3. **Missing Not at Random (MNAR):** The observation probability depends on the current value X_t , even after conditioning on the past:

$$P(O_t = 1 \mid X_t, \mathcal{F}_{t-1}) \neq P(O_t = 1 \mid \mathcal{F}_{t-1}).$$

Remark 3.2. While Rubin’s framework was originally developed for i.i.d. data, similar concepts have been considered in longitudinal and time series settings (see, e.g., Diggle et al., 2002). The formulation adopted here extends the conditioning to the full history of the process.

The assumption under which the subsequent results are derived is that (O_t) and (X_t) are *independent*, which corresponds to the MCAR case. This is the strongest of the three assumptions and implies in particular that the corrected estimator $\hat{f}^*$ introduced in Section 3.2 is consistent. Under MAR or MNAR, the independence assumption fails and the estimator may be biased a point we return to in Section ??.

3.2. Amplitude Modulation

Definition of the observation process

To model the missingness, the concept of **amplitude modulation** is employed. This approach models missingness through a binary stochastic process $(O_t)_t$ that runs concurrently with the main process $(X_t)_t$ and modulates its "amplitude" in a binary manner:

$$O_t \in \{0, 1\} \quad \forall t$$

where $O_t = 1$ indicates that X_t is fully observed (amplitude = 1), and $O_t = 0$ indicates that X_t is missing (amplitude = 0).

The amplitude modulating process O_t can be:

- **Deterministic:** For each t , $O_t = o_t$ where $o_t \in \{0, 1\}$ is a known, fixed value.
- **Stochastic:** O_t follows a probability distribution with $\pi_t := P(O_t = 1)$, possibly dependent on the history of X_t , O_t , or external factors.

Bias of the naive estimator

The amplitude modulation is applied to the binarization vector $\mathbf{Z}_t$ to obtain the observable process $(O_t \mathbf{Z}_t)$. We then define the naive estimator of $\mathbf{f}$ as:

$$\hat{\mathbf{f}} := \frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^n O_t \mathbf{Z}_t.$$

To assess the performance of this naive estimator we compute its expectation

$$\mathbb{E}[\hat{\mathbf{f}}] = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^n \mathbb{E}[O_t \mathbf{Z}_t] = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^n \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{Z}_t \mathbb{E}[O_t | \mathbf{Z}_t]],$$

where the last equality follows from the law of iterated expectations.

The dependence structure between $(O_t)_t$ and $(\mathbf{Z}_t)_t$ (or equivalently $(X_t)_t$) is crucial. Under the assumption of independence (see Definition 3.1, part MCAR), the expression simplifies to

$$\frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^n \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{Z}_t \mathbb{E}[O_t | \mathbf{Z}_t]] = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^n \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{Z}_t] \mathbb{E}[O_t] = \left(\frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^n \mathbb{E}[O_t] \right) \mathbf{f}$$

The missingness corrected estimator

Definition 3.3 (Corrected Estimator of $\mathbf{f}$). Since $E[\hat{\mathbf{f}}]$ deviates from $\mathbf{f}$ by the factor $\frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^n E[O_t]$, the corrected estimator of $\mathbf{f}$ is defined as

$$\hat{\mathbf{f}}^* := \frac{\frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^n O_t \mathbf{Z}_t}{\frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^n O_t} =: \frac{\hat{\mathbf{f}}}{\bar{O}}.$$

Under the assumption of the independence of (O_t) and (X_t) , the stochastic properties of the corrected estimator $\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*$ can be studied. If (O_t) is deterministic, then $E[O_t] = o_t \in \{0, 1\}$ for any given t . It follows that

$$\frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^n E[O_t] = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^n O_t = \bar{O},$$

and therefore, here $\hat{\mathbf{f}}^* = \hat{\mathbf{f}}/\bar{O}$ is a perfectly unbiased estimator of $\mathbf{f}$. However, if O_t is a stochastic process then $E[O_t] = \pi_t \in (0; 1]$ and

$$\frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^n E[O_t] = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^n \pi_t \neq \frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^n O_t = \bar{O},$$

to where $\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*$ is generally biased.

3.3. Asymptotic Theory for the corrected estimator

The extended process - stationarity and α -mixing

To study this bias we assume (O_t) and (X_t) to be stationary and α -mixing with exponentially decaying coefficients (see Definition 2.2), with $E[O_t] = \pi$, a autocovariance function $\gamma_O(h) := \text{Cov}[O_h, O_0]$ and joint expectations $\pi(h) := E[O_h O_0] = \gamma_O(h) + \pi^2$. To study the joint asymptotic distribution of the estimator $\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*$, we introduce the extended binary vectors in order to derive the joint asymptotic distribution of all sample averages entering its definition:

$$\mathbf{Z}_t^* := (O_t, O_t Z_{t,0}, \dots, O_t Z_{t,m-1})^\top = O_t (1, \mathbf{Z}_t^\top)^\top,$$

where the elements of $\mathbf{Z}_t^*$ are numbered as $Z_{t,-1}^*, Z_{t,0}^*, \dots, Z_{t,m-1}^*$. The expectation of $\mathbf{Z}_t^*$ is given by

$$\begin{aligned} E[\mathbf{Z}_t^*] &= (E[O_t], E[O_t Z_{t,0}], \dots, E[O_t Z_{t,m-1}])^\top \\ &= (E[O_t], E[O_t]E[Z_{t,0}], \dots, E[O_t]E[Z_{t,m-1}])^\top && \text{(Independence)} \\ &= (\pi, \pi f_0, \dots, \pi f_{m-1})^\top \\ &= \pi(1, \mathbf{f}^\top)^\top =: \boldsymbol{\mu}_{\mathbf{Z}_t^*}. \end{aligned}$$

Since the processes (O_t) and $(\mathbf{Z}_t)$ are independent and stationary, the joint process $((O_t, \mathbf{Z}_t)^\top)$ is also stationary. Moreover, if both processes are α -mixing, then the joint process is α -mixing. As $\mathbf{Z}_t^*$ is a measurable function of $(O_t, \mathbf{Z})^\top$ it follows that $\mathbf{Z}_t^*$ is stationary and α -mixing (with exponentially decaying coefficients).

Multivariate CLT

Proposition 3.4 (Asymptotic distribution of $\bar{\mathbf{Z}}_n^*$). *Let (X_t) and (O_t) be independent, strictly stationary and α -mixing with exponentially decaying coefficients, with $\mathbb{E}[O_t] = \pi \in (0, 1]$. Define the extended process*

$$\mathbf{Z}_t^* := O_t(1, \mathbf{Z}_t^\top)^\top \in \mathbb{R}^{m+1},$$

with sample mean $\bar{\mathbf{Z}}_n^* := \frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^n \mathbf{Z}_t^*$. Then

$$\sqrt{n}(\bar{\mathbf{Z}}_n^* - \boldsymbol{\mu}_{\mathbf{Z}^*}) \xrightarrow{d} \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{0}, \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{\mathbf{Z}^*}),$$

where $\boldsymbol{\mu}_{\mathbf{Z}^*} = \pi(1, \mathbf{f}^\top)^\top$ and

$$\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{\mathbf{Z}^*} = \text{Var}(\mathbf{Z}_t^*) + 2 \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \text{Cov}(\mathbf{Z}_t^*, \mathbf{Z}_{t+h}^*),$$

with elements $\sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*, i, j}$ as given in cases (i)–(iii) below.

Proof. Since $U_t^* = \mathbf{a}^\top \mathbf{Z}_t^*$ is a measurable function of the strictly stationary and α -mixing process $\mathbf{Z}_t^*$, it inherits both properties, with $\alpha_{U_t^*}(n) \leq \alpha_{\mathbf{Z}_t^*}(n) \leq C\rho^n$ following from the inclusion $\sigma(U_t^*) \subset \sigma(\mathbf{Z}_t^*)$. The summability condition therefore holds by the same geometric series argument as in Theorem 2.3. Since each $Z_{t,i}^* \in \{0, 1\}$, the projection U_t^* is bounded and all moments are finite. Ibragimov's CLT (Ibragimov, 1962, Theorem 7) therefore applies to U_t^* , and the Cramér–Wold theorem (Kallenberg, 2021, Corollary 4.5) yields the multivariate result. $\square$

Remark 3.5 (Elements of $\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{\mathbf{Z}^*}$). Note that since $O_t \in \{0, 1\}$ with $\mathbb{P}(O_t = 1) = \pi$, it follows that $O_t \sim \text{Bernoulli}(\pi)$, so that $\mathbb{E}[O_t] = \pi$, $\text{Var}(O_t) = \pi(1 - \pi)$, and $\mathbb{E}[O_t^2] = \pi$. Recall also that $\mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t+h}] = \pi(h) = \gamma_O(h) + \pi^2$ for all $h \in \mathbb{N}$. The individual elements

of $\Sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*}$ are then given by

(i) $i = j = -1$:

$$\begin{aligned} & \text{Var}(O_t) + 2 \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \text{Cov}(O_t, O_{t+h}) \\ &= \pi(1 - \pi) + 2 \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \gamma_O(h) =: \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, -1} \end{aligned}$$

(ii) $j > i = -1$:

$$\begin{aligned} & \text{Cov}(O_t, O_t Z_{t,j}) + 2 \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \text{Cov}(O_t, O_{t+h} Z_{t+h,j}) \\ &= f_j \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, -1} \end{aligned}$$

(iii) $i, j \geq 0$:

$$\begin{aligned} & \text{Cov}(O_t Z_{t,i}, O_t Z_{t,j}) + \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} [\text{Cov}(O_t Z_{t,i}, O_{t+h} Z_{t+h,j}) + \text{Cov}(O_{t+h} Z_{t+h,i}, O_t Z_{t,j})] \\ &= f_i f_j \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, -1} + \pi(f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) + \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \pi(h)(f_{ij}(h) + f_{ji}(h) - 2f_i f_j) \end{aligned}$$

The detailed derivations of these expressions are provided in Appendix A.1.

To now derive the asymptotic properties of $\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*$ we define the vector-valued function $\mathbf{g} := [0, 1]^{m+1} \rightarrow [0, 1]^m$ as

$$g_j(x_{-1}, x_0, \dots, x_{m-1}) = x_j / x_{-1}, \quad \text{for } j = 0 \dots, m-1,$$

such that

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{g}(\bar{\mathbf{Z}}_t^*) &= (g_0(\bar{\mathbf{Z}}_t^*), \dots, g_{m-1}(\bar{\mathbf{Z}}_t^*))^\top = (\hat{f}_0 O_t / O_t, \dots, \hat{f}_{m-1} O_t / O_t)^\top \\ &= \hat{\mathbf{f}}^* \end{aligned}$$

and accordingly

$$g(\bar{\boldsymbol{\mu}}_{\mathbf{Z}^*}^*) = \mathbf{f}.$$

The Jacobian of $\mathbf{g}(\mathbf{x})$ evaluated at $\mathbf{x} = \boldsymbol{\mu}_{\mathbf{Z}^*}$ is given by

$$\mathbf{G}_{(m+1) \times m} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{\partial g_0(\boldsymbol{\mu}_{\mathbf{Z}^*})}{\partial x_{-1}} & \dots & \frac{\partial g_0(\boldsymbol{\mu}_{\mathbf{Z}^*})}{\partial x_{m-1}} \\ \vdots & \dots & \vdots \\ \frac{\partial g_{m-1}(\boldsymbol{\mu}_{\mathbf{Z}^*})}{\partial x_{-1}} & \dots & \frac{\partial g_{m-1}(\boldsymbol{\mu}_{\mathbf{Z}^*})}{\partial x_{m-1}} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{f_0}{\pi} & \frac{1}{\pi} & 0 & \dots & 0 \\ -\frac{f_1}{\pi} & 0 & \frac{1}{\pi} & \ddots & \vdots \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \ddots & 0 \\ -\frac{f_{m-1}}{\pi} & 0 & \dots & 0 & \frac{1}{\pi} \end{pmatrix}$$

Then, following the delta method, we have the following result

Theorem 3.6 (Asymptotic Normality of $\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*$). *Let (X_t) be a strictly stationary, ordinal process that is α -mixing with exponentially decaying coefficients. Let the modulating process (O_t) also be strictly stationary and α -mixing with exponentially decaying coefficients, with moments $E[O_t] = \pi > 0$ and $E[O_h O_0] = \pi(h) > 0$. Furthermore, let (O_t) and (X_t) be independent, where X_t is observed if $O_t = 1$. Then the corrected estimator from definition 3.3 satisfies the following multivariate CLT:*

$$\sqrt{n}(\hat{\mathbf{f}}^* - \mathbf{f}) \xrightarrow[n \rightarrow \infty]{d} \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{0}, \Sigma_{\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*}), \quad \text{with } \Sigma_{\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*} = (\sigma_{\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*; i, j})_{i, j=0, \dots, m-1}, \quad (3.1)$$

where

$$\sigma_{\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*; i, j} = \frac{1}{\pi}(f_{\min\{i, j\}} - f_i f_j) + \frac{1}{\pi^2} \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \pi(h)(f_{ij}(h) + f_{ji}(h) - 2f_i f_j). \quad (3.2)$$

The structure of $\Sigma_{\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*}$ can be computed as follows

$$\begin{aligned} \Sigma_{\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*} &= \mathbf{G} \Sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*} \mathbf{G}^\top \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{f_0}{\pi} & \frac{1}{\pi} & 0 & \dots & 0 \\ -\frac{f_1}{\pi} & 0 & \frac{1}{\pi} & \ddots & \vdots \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \ddots & 0 \\ -\frac{f_{m-1}}{\pi} & 0 & \dots & 0 & \frac{1}{\pi} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, -1} & \dots & \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, m-1} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; m-1, -1} & \dots & \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; m-1, m-1} \end{pmatrix} \mathbf{G}^\top \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{f_0}{\pi} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, -1} + \frac{1}{\pi} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; 0, -1} & \dots & -\frac{f_0}{\pi} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, m-1} + \frac{1}{\pi} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; 0, m-1} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ -\frac{f_{m-1}}{\pi} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, -1} + \frac{1}{\pi} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; m-1, -1} & \dots & -\frac{f_{m-1}}{\pi} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, m-1} + \frac{1}{\pi} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; m-1, m-1} \end{pmatrix} \mathbf{G}^\top. \end{aligned}$$

Such that the individual elements look like this:

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma_{\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*; i, j} &= \left(-\frac{f_j}{\pi}\right) \left(-\frac{f_i}{\pi} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, -1} + \frac{1}{\pi} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; i, -1}\right) + \frac{1}{\pi} \left(-\frac{f_i}{\pi} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, j} + \frac{1}{\pi} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; i, j}\right) \\ &= \frac{f_j f_i}{\pi^2} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, -1} - \frac{f_j}{\pi^2} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; i, -1} - \frac{f_i}{\pi^2} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, j} + \frac{1}{\pi^2} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; i, j} \\ &= \frac{1}{\pi^2} (f_i f_j \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, -1} - f_i f_j \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, -1} - f_i f_j \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, -1} + \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; i, j}) = \frac{1}{\pi^2} (\sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; i, j} - f_i f_j \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, -1}) \\ &= \frac{1}{\pi^2} \left(\left[f_i f_j \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, -1} + \pi(f_{\min\{i, j\}} - f_i f_j) + \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \pi(h) f_{ij}(h) + f_{ji}(h) - 2f_i f_j \right] - f_i f_j \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, -1} \right) \\ &= \underbrace{\frac{1}{\pi}(f_{\min\{i, j\}} - f_i f_j)}_{\text{lag}(0)} + \underbrace{\frac{1}{\pi^2} \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \pi(h) (f_{ij}(h) + f_{ji}(h) - 2f_i f_j)}_{\text{lag}(h)} \end{aligned}$$

Here, the lag-0 term captures the contemporaneous covariance structure of the observed process, while the lag- h terms accumulate the serial dependence across all lags $h \geq 1$.

Bias analysis

Since g_j is not a linear function of $\mathbf{Z}_t^*$, the bias of order $O(n^{-1})$ is computable using a second-order Taylor expansion. The Hessian of g_j evaluated in $\boldsymbol{\mu}_{\mathbf{Z}^*}$ is given by

$$\mathbf{H}_{g_j} = \left(\frac{\partial^2 g_j(\boldsymbol{\mu}_{\mathbf{Z}^*})}{\partial x_i \partial x_k} \right)_{i,k=-1,\dots,m-1} = \begin{cases} \frac{2f_j}{\pi^2} & \text{if } i = k = -1 \\ -\frac{1}{\pi^2} & \text{if } i = -1, k = j \\ 0 & \text{else.} \end{cases}$$

Using the symmetry $\sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*;-1,j} = \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*;j,-1}$ and the equality from Lemma 2.4 the bias simplifies to

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Bias}(\hat{f}_j) &= \frac{1}{2} \text{tr}(\mathbf{H}_{g_j} \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{\mathbf{Z}^*}) \\ &= \frac{1}{2} h_{g_j;-1,-1} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*;-1,-1} + h_{g_j;-1,j} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*;-1,j} \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \cdot \frac{2f_j}{\pi^2} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*;-1,-1} - \frac{1}{\pi^2} \cdot f_j \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*;-1,-1} \\ &= \frac{f_j}{\pi^2} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*;-1,-1} - \frac{f_j}{\pi^2} \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*;-1,-1} = 0, \end{aligned}$$

where the last step uses $\sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*;-1,j} = f_j \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*;-1,-1}$ from case (ii) of $\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{\mathbf{Z}^*}$.

Special Cases

To further study the asymptotic distribution of $\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*$, we consider three special cases of the general result.

Corollary 3.7 (Full Observation). *If the process is fully observed, i.e. $\pi = 1$, then*

$$\sigma_{\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*;i,j} = (f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) + \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} f_{ij}(h) + f_{ji}(h) - 2f_i f_j = \sigma_{\mathbf{Z};i,j}.$$

That is, the asymptotic covariance of $\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*$ reduces to that of the complete-data estimator $\hat{\mathbf{f}}$, as one would expect.

Corollary 3.8 (i.i.d. Observation Process). *If (O_t) is i.i.d., then $\pi(h) = \pi^2$ for all $h \geq 1$, and the asymptotic covariance simplifies to*

$$\sigma_{\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*;i,j} = \frac{1}{\pi} (f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) + \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} f_{ij}(h) + f_{ji}(h) - 2f_i f_j.$$

Compared to the complete-data case, the lag-0 term is inflated by a factor of $1/\pi \geq 1$, reflecting the additional uncertainty introduced by the random missingness. The lag- h terms for $h \geq 1$, however, are unaffected, since i.i.d. missingness introduces no additional serial dependence into the observation process.

Corollary 3.9 (i.i.d. Main Process). *If (X_t) is i.i.d., then $f_{ij}(h) = f_i f_j$ for all $i, j = 0, \dots, m-1$ and $h \geq 1$, so that the asymptotic covariance reduces to*

$$\sigma_{\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*; i, j} = \frac{1}{\pi} (f_{\min\{i, j\}} - f_i f_j) + \frac{1}{\pi^2} \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \pi(h) \overbrace{(f_{ij}(h) + f_{ji}(h) - 2f_i f_j)}^{=0} = \frac{1}{\pi} (f_{\min\{i, j\}} - f_i f_j).$$

When the main process is serially independent, all temporal dependence in $\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*$ vanishes and the asymptotic covariance only depends on the lag-0 term.

3.4. Asymptotic marginal properties

The asymptotic properties of marginal statistics based on $\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*$ follow directly from the delta method, in exact analogy to the complete-data case. The following results are for the IOV and the skew. However, the derivations for other marginal statistics are analogous.

Corollary 3.10 (Asymptotic distribution of $\text{IOV}(\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*)$). *Under the conditions of Theorem 3.6, the delta method argument from Theorem 2.5 carries over to the missing-data case with Σ_Z replaced by $\Sigma_{\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*}$, yielding*

$$\sqrt{n} \text{Var}(\text{IOV}(\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*)) \stackrel{\text{asy.}}{=} \frac{16}{m^2} \sum_{i, j=0}^{m-1} (1 - 2f_i)(1 - 2f_j) \sigma_{\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*; i, j}.$$

Moreover, since $\mathbf{H}_{\text{IOV}} = -\frac{8}{m} \mathbf{I}_m$ remains diagonal, the bias to order n^{-1} depends only on the marginal variances of $\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*$:

$$\text{Bias}(\text{IOV}(\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*)) = -\frac{4}{mn} \sum_{i=0}^{m-1} \sigma_{\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*; i, i}.$$

Remark 3.11 (Skew under missingness). The analogous result for the skew follows immediately, since the skew is linear in $\mathbf{f}$ and hence $\mathbf{H}_{\text{skew}} = 0$. In particular, the estimator is unbiased and its asymptotic variance is given by

$$\sqrt{n} \text{Var}(\text{skew}(\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*)) \stackrel{\text{asy.}}{=} \frac{4}{m^2} \sum_{i, j=0}^{m-1} \sigma_{\hat{\mathbf{f}}^*; i, j}.$$

3.5. Serial Dependence

3.6. Serial Dependence

So far, we have only examined aspects of the marginal distribution of the categorical process (X_t) . However, an essential component of time series analysis is the study of serial dependence. Recall that the most widely used measures to describe such dependence

are the ordinal and nominal Cohen's κ (Definition 1.5). To estimate these measures, we again rely on relative frequencies:

$$\hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}(h) = \frac{\sum_{j=0}^{m-1} \left(\hat{f}_{jj}^*(h) - (\hat{f}_j^*)^2 \right)}{\sum_{i=0}^{m-1} \hat{f}_i^* (1 - \hat{f}_i^*)}.$$

Hence, it remains to define the estimator $\hat{f}_{ij}^*(h)$ for the bivariate lag- h probabilities $f_{ij}(h)$. As before, we begin with the naive estimator given by the bivariate relative frequency of the amplitude-modulated binarizations,

$$\hat{f}_{ij}(h) = \frac{1}{n-h} \sum_{t=h+1}^n O_t O_{t-h} Z_{t,i} Z_{t-h,j},$$

and compute its expectation:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}[\hat{f}_{ij}(h)] &= \frac{1}{n-h} \sum_{t=h+1}^n \mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t-h} Z_{t,i} Z_{t-h,j}] \\ &= \frac{1}{n-h} \sum_{t=h+1}^n \mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t-h}] \cdot \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,i} Z_{t-h,j}] \\ &= \left(\frac{1}{n-h} \sum_{t=h+1}^n \mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t-h}] \right) f_{ij}(h), \end{aligned}$$

where the second equality follows from the independence of (O_t) and (X_t) , and the third from the stationarity of (X_t) . This motivates the corrected estimator

$$\hat{f}_{ij}^*(h) = \frac{\frac{1}{n-h} \sum_{t=h+1}^n O_t O_{t-h} Z_{t,i} Z_{t-h,j}}{\frac{1}{n-h} \sum_{t=h+1}^n O_t O_{t-h}} =: \hat{f}_{ij}(h) / \overline{OO}_h.$$

As in Section 3.2, the properties of this estimator depend on whether (O_t) is deterministic or stochastic. If (O_t) is deterministic, the corrected estimator is exactly unbiased. In the stochastic case, both numerator and denominator are random and depend on the same process (O_t) , so that in general

$$\mathbb{E} \left[\frac{\hat{f}_{ij}(h)}{\overline{OO}_h} \right] \neq \frac{\mathbb{E}[\hat{f}_{ij}(h)]}{\mathbb{E}[\overline{OO}_h]},$$

and hence $\hat{f}_{ij}^*(h)$ is generally biased.

3.6.1. Asymptotic distribution under the general model

To derive the asymptotic distribution of $\hat{f}_{ij}^*(h)$, we proceed analogously to Section 3.2 and apply the Cramér–Wold device to the sample mean of a suitably defined binary vector:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{Z}_t^{(h)*} &= \left(Z_{t,-2}^{(h)*}, Z_{t,-1}^{(h)*}, \overbrace{\dots, Z_{t,i}^{(h)*}}^{i=0, \dots, m-1}, \overbrace{\dots, Z_{t,m+j}^{(h)*}}^{j=0, \dots, m-1}, \dots \right)^\top \\ &:= \left(O_t O_{t-h}, \underbrace{O_t, \dots, O_t Z_{t,i}, \dots}_{=\mathbf{Z}_t^*}, \dots, O_t O_{t-h} Z_{t,j} Z_{t-h,j}, \dots \right)^\top. \end{aligned}$$

The components of $\mathbf{Z}_t^{(h)*}$ are indexed from -2 to $2m-1$: the component at index -2 captures the product $O_t O_{t-h}$, the components at indices -1 through $m-1$ coincide with $\mathbf{Z}_t^*$ from Section 3.2, and the remaining components at indices m through $2m-1$ capture the lag- h interaction terms $O_t O_{t-h} Z_{t,j} Z_{t-h,j}$. Since κ_{ord} depends only on the diagonal frequencies $\hat{f}_{jj}^*(h)$, it suffices to include the corresponding diagonal components in $\mathbf{Z}_t^{(h)*}$. Should one wish to study a dependence measure that also involves off-diagonal frequencies $\hat{f}_{ij}^*(h)$ with $i \neq j$, the vector can straightforwardly be extended by the additional components $O_t O_{t-h} Z_{t,i} Z_{t-h,j}$.

Since $\mathbf{Z}_t^{(h)*}$ is a measurable function of $(O_t, O_{t-h}, X_t, X_{t-h})$, it inherits strict stationarity and α -mixing with exponentially decaying coefficients from the underlying processes by the same argument as in Section 3.2, and all moment conditions are trivially satisfied as its components are bounded indicator variables. The Cramér–Wold device therefore yields

$$\sqrt{n} \left(\bar{\mathbf{Z}}_n^{(h)*} - \boldsymbol{\mu}_{\mathbf{Z}^{(h)*}} \right) \xrightarrow{d} \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{0}, \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{\mathbf{Z}^{(h)*}}),$$

where $\bar{\mathbf{Z}}_n^{(h)*} := \frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^n \mathbf{Z}_t^{(h)*}$ and

$$\boldsymbol{\mu}_{\mathbf{Z}^{(h)*}} = \left(\pi(h), \pi, \pi \mathbf{f}^\top, \pi(h) f_{00}(h), \dots, \pi(h) f_{m-1, m-1}(h) \right)^\top.$$

The long-run covariance matrix $\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{\mathbf{Z}^{(h)*}}$ has elements

$$\sigma_{i,j}^{(h)} = \text{Cov}(Z_{t,i}^{(h)*}, Z_{t,j}^{(h)*}) + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \left[\text{Cov}(Z_{t,i}^{(h)*}, Z_{t+k,j}^{(h)*}) + \text{Cov}(Z_{t+k,i}^{(h)*}, Z_{t,j}^{(h)*}) \right].$$

Using the independence of (O_t) and (X_t) , these can be computed explicitly. We record the following notation: since $O_t \sim \text{Bernoulli}(\pi)$, we have $\mathbb{E}[O_t] = \pi$, $\text{Var}(O_t) = \pi(1-\pi)$, $\mathbb{E}[O_t^2] = \pi$, and we write $\pi(h) := \mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t-h}]$ and $\gamma_O(h) := \text{Cov}(O_t, O_{t-h}) = \pi(h) - \pi^2$ for all $h \geq 1$. The elements of $\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{\mathbf{Z}^{(h)*}}$ are then given as follows:

(i) $i = j = -2$:

$$\begin{aligned}
& \text{Var}(O_t O_{t-h}) + 2 \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \text{Cov}(O_t O_{t-h}, O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h}) \\
&= \pi(h)(1 - \pi(h)) + 2 \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} (\mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t-h} O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h}] - \pi(h)^2)
\end{aligned}$$

(ii) $i = -2, j = -1$:

$$\begin{aligned}
& \text{Cov}(O_t O_{t-h}, O_t) + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} [\text{Cov}(O_t O_{t-h}, O_{t+k}) + \text{Cov}(O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h}, O_t)] \\
&= (1 - \pi)\pi(h) + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} [\mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t-h} O_{t+k}] + \mathbb{E}[O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h} O_t] - 2\pi\pi(h)] =: \sigma_{-2,-1}^{(h)}
\end{aligned}$$

(iii) $i = -2, j = 0, \dots, m-1$:

$$\begin{aligned}
& \text{Cov}(O_t O_{t-h}, O_t Z_{t,j}) + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} [\text{Cov}(O_t O_{t-h}, O_{t+k} Z_{t+k,j}) + \text{Cov}(O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h}, O_t Z_{t,j})] \\
&\stackrel{\perp}{=} \mathbb{E}[O_t^2 O_{t-h}] \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,j}] - \pi(h) \pi \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,j}] \\
&\quad + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} [\mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t-h} O_{t+k}] \mathbb{E}[Z_{t+k,j}] + \mathbb{E}[O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h} O_t] \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,j}] - 2\pi\pi(h) \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,j}]] \\
&= f_j \left((1 - \pi)\pi(h) + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} [\mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t-h} O_{t+k}] + \mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h}] - 2\pi\pi(h)] \right) = f_j \sigma_{-2,-1}^{(h)}
\end{aligned}$$

(iv) $i = -2, j = m, \dots, 2m-1$:

$$\begin{aligned}
& \text{Cov}(O_t O_{t-h}, O_t O_{t-h} Z_{t,(j-m)} Z_{t-h,(j-m)}) \\
&\quad + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} [\text{Cov}(O_t O_{t-h}, O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h} Z_{t+k,(j-m)} Z_{t+k-h,(j-m)}) \\
&\quad + \text{Cov}(O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h}, O_t O_{t-h} Z_{t,(j-m)} Z_{t-h,(j-m)})] \\
&\stackrel{\perp}{=} \mathbb{E}[O_t^2 O_{t-h}^2] \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,(j-m)} Z_{t-h,(j-m)}] - \pi(h)^2 f_{(j-m),(j-m)}(h) \\
&\quad + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t-h} O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h}] [\mathbb{E}[Z_{t+k,(j-m)} Z_{t+k-h,(j-m)}] + \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,(j-m)} Z_{t-h,(j-m)}]] - 2\pi(h)^2 f_{(j-m),(j-m)}(h) \\
&= f_{(j-m),(j-m)}(h) \left(\pi(h)(1 - \pi(h)) + 2 \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} [\mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t-h} O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h}] - \pi(h)^2] \right) =: f_{(j-m),(j-m)}(h) \sigma_{-2,-2}^{(h)}
\end{aligned}$$

(v) $i = j = -1$:

$$\text{Var}(O_t) + 2 \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \text{Cov}(O_t, O_{t+k}) = \pi(1 - \pi) + 2 \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \gamma_O(k) = \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*, -1, -1}$$

(vi) $i = -1, j = 0, \dots, m-1$:

$$\text{Cov}(O_t, O_t Z_{t,j}) + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} [\text{Cov}(O_t, O_{t+k} Z_{t+k,j}) + \text{Cov}(O_{t+k}, O_t Z_{t,j})] = f_j \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*, -1, -1}$$

(vii) $i = -1, j = m, \dots, 2m - 1 :$

$$\begin{aligned}
& \text{Cov}(O_t, O_t O_{t-h} Z_{t,(j-m)} Z_{t-h,(j-m)}) \\
& + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} [\text{Cov}(O_t, O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h} Z_{t+k,(j-m)} Z_{t+k-h,(j-m)}) + \text{Cov}(O_{t+k}, O_t O_{t-h} Z_{t,(j-m)} Z_{t-h,(j-m)})] \\
& \stackrel{\perp}{=} f_{(j-m),(j-m)}(h) \left((1 - \pi)\pi(h) + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} [\mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h}] + \mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t+k} O_{t-h}] - 2\pi\pi(h)] \right) \\
& = f_{(j-m),(j-m)}(h) \sigma_{-2,-1}^{(h)}
\end{aligned}$$

(viii) $i, j = 0, \dots, m - 1 :$

$$\begin{aligned}
& \text{Cov}(O_t Z_{t,i}, O_t Z_{t,j}) + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} [\text{Cov}(O_t Z_{t,i}, O_{t+k} Z_{t+k,j}) + \text{Cov}(O_{t+k} Z_{t+k,i}, O_t Z_{t,j})] \\
& = \sigma_{Z^*, i, j} = f_i f_j \sigma_{Z^*, -1, -1} + \pi(f_{\min\{i, j\}} - f_i f_j) + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \pi(k) (f_{ij}(k) + f_{ji}(k) - 2f_i f_j)
\end{aligned}$$

(ix) $i = 0, \dots, m - 1, j = m, \dots, 2m - 1 :$

$$\begin{aligned}
& \text{Cov}(O_t Z_{t,i}, O_t O_{t-h} Z_{t,(j-m)} Z_{t-h,(j-m)}) \\
& + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} [\text{Cov}(O_t Z_{t,i}, O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h} Z_{t+k,(j-m)} Z_{t+k-h,(j-m)}) \\
& + \text{Cov}(O_{t+k} Z_{t+k,i}, O_t O_{t-h} Z_{t,(j-m)} Z_{t-h,(j-m)})] \\
& \stackrel{\perp}{=} \pi(h) \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,i} Z_{t,(j-m)} Z_{t-h,(j-m)}] - \pi\pi(h) f_i f_{(j-m),(j-m)}(h) \\
& + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} [\mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h}] \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,i} Z_{t+k,(j-m)} Z_{t+k-h,(j-m)}] \\
& + \mathbb{E}[O_{t+k} O_t O_{t-h}] \mathbb{E}[Z_{t+k,i} Z_{t,(j-m)} Z_{t-h,(j-m)}] - 2\pi\pi(h) f_i f_{(j-m),(j-m)}(h)]
\end{aligned}$$

(x) $i, j = m, \dots, 2m - 1 :$

$$\begin{aligned}
& \text{Cov}(O_t O_{t-h} Z_{t,(i-m)} Z_{t-h,(i-m)}, O_t O_{t-h} Z_{t,(j-m)} Z_{t-h,(j-m)}) \\
& + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} [\text{Cov}(O_t O_{t-h} Z_{t,(i-m)} Z_{t-h,(i-m)}, O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h} Z_{t+k,(j-m)} Z_{t+k-h,(j-m)}) \\
& + \text{Cov}(O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h} Z_{t+k,(i-m)} Z_{t+k-h,(i-m)}, O_t O_{t-h} Z_{t,(j-m)} Z_{t-h,(j-m)})] \\
& \stackrel{\perp}{=} \pi(h) \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,(i-m)} Z_{t-h,(i-m)} Z_{t,(j-m)} Z_{t-h,(j-m)}] - \pi(h)^2 f_{(i-m),(i-m)}(h) f_{(j-m),(j-m)}(h) \\
& + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t-h} O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h}] [\mathbb{E}[Z_{t,(i-m)} Z_{t-h,(i-m)} Z_{t+k,(j-m)} Z_{t+k-h,(j-m)}] \\
& + \mathbb{E}[Z_{t+k,(i-m)} Z_{t+k-h,(i-m)} Z_{t,(j-m)} Z_{t-h,(j-m)}] - 2f_{(i-m),(i-m)}(h) f_{(j-m),(j-m)}(h)]
\end{aligned}$$

Note that cases (v), (vi) and (viii) coincide with cases (i)-(iii) from Σ_{Z^*} of proposition 3.4. Also note that cases (i)-(viii) admit fully explicit closed-form expressions, whereas cases (ix) and (x) involve third- and fourth-order mixed moments of (X_t) such as $\mathbb{E}[Z_{t,i} Z_{t,(j-m)} Z_{t-h,(j-m)}]$ that do not simplify further without additional assumptions on the dependence structure of (X_t) .

To obtain the joint asymptotic distribution of $\hat{f}_i^*$ and $\hat{f}_{jj}^*(h)$ for all $i, j = 0, \dots, m-1$, we define the vector-valued function $\mathbf{g}: [0, 1]^{2(m+1)} \rightarrow [0, 1]^{2m}$ by

$$g_j(\mathbf{x}) = \begin{cases} x_j/x_{-1} & \text{for } j = 0, \dots, m-1, \\ x_j/x_{-2} & \text{for } j = m, \dots, 2m-1, \end{cases}$$

so that

$$\hat{\mathbf{f}}^{(h)*} := \mathbf{g}(\bar{\mathbf{Z}}_n^{(h)*}) \quad \text{and} \quad \boldsymbol{\mu}^{(h)*} := \mathbf{g}(\boldsymbol{\mu}_{\mathbf{Z}^{(h)*}}) = (f_0, \dots, f_{m-1}, f_{00}(h), \dots, f_{m-1, m-1}(h))^\top.$$

By the multivariate delta method (van der Vaart, 1998, Chapter 3),

$$\sqrt{n}(\hat{\mathbf{f}}^{(h)*} - \boldsymbol{\mu}^{(h)*}) \xrightarrow{d} \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{0}, \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{\mathbf{f}^{(h)*}}), \quad \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{\mathbf{f}^{(h)*}} = \mathbf{G} \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{\mathbf{Z}^{(h)*}} \mathbf{G}^\top,$$

where the Jacobian $\mathbf{G}_{2m \times 2(m+1)}$, evaluated at $\boldsymbol{\mu}_{\mathbf{Z}^{(h)*}}$, is given by

$$\mathbf{G} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & \frac{-f_0}{\pi} & \frac{1}{\pi} & 0 & \dots & \dots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & 0 & \ddots & \ddots & & \vdots \\ 0 & \frac{-f_{m-1}}{\pi} & \vdots & \ddots & \frac{1}{\pi} & & \vdots \\ \frac{-f_{00}(h)}{\pi(h)} & 0 & & & \frac{1}{\pi(h)} & \ddots & \vdots \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & & \ddots & \ddots & 0 \\ \frac{-f_{m-1, m-1}(h)}{\pi(h)} & 0 & 0 & \dots & \dots & 0 & \frac{1}{\pi(h)} \end{pmatrix}.$$

Since explicit closed-form expressions for the elements of $\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{\mathbf{f}^{(h)*}}$ require higher-order mixed moments of (X_t) , a fully general evaluation of $\mathbf{G} \boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{\mathbf{Z}^{(h)*}} \mathbf{G}^\top$ is intractable without further assumptions. We therefore proceed in two steps: first, in section 3.6.2, we narrow our focus to the asymptotic null distribution of $\sqrt{n} \hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}(h)$, under which the i.i.d. assumption on (X_t) yields the simplifications needed for closed-form results. Second, in section 3.6.3, we return to the general model and show that the test is consistent under H_A , without requiring explicit expressions for $\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{\mathbf{f}^{(h)*}}$.

3.6.2. Asymptotic null distribution under H_0

Under the null hypothesis H_0 that (X_t) is i.i.d., the condition $f_{ij}(h) = f_i f_j$ holds for all $h \geq 1$. This considerably simplifies the third- and fourth-order mixed moments of $\mathbf{Z}_t^{(h)*}$ appearing in cases (ix) and (x) of $\boldsymbol{\Sigma}_{\mathbf{Z}^{(h)*}}$. Before carrying out the simplifications, we

collect the relevant moments under H_0 , which will be used repeatedly below:

$$\mathbb{E}[Z_{t,i}Z_{t-h,i}Z_{t-k,j}Z_{t-k-h,j}] - f_{ii}(h)f_{jj}(h) = \begin{cases} f_{\min\{i,j\}}^2 - f_i^2 f_j^2 & \text{if } k = 0, \\ f_i f_j f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j^2 & \text{if } k = h, \\ 0 & \text{else,} \end{cases}$$

$$\mathbb{E}[Z_{t+k,i}Z_{t,j}Z_{t-h,j}] - f_i f_{jj}(h) = \begin{cases} f_j f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j^2 & \text{if } k = 0, \\ 0 & \text{else,} \end{cases}$$

$$\mathbb{E}[Z_{t,i}Z_{t+k,j}Z_{t+k-h,j}] - f_i f_{jj}(h) = \begin{cases} f_j f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j^2 & \text{if } k = 0 \text{ or } k = h, \\ 0 & \text{else.} \end{cases}$$

Applying these simplifications to cases **(ix)** and **(x)** of $\Sigma_{Z^{(h)*}}$ yields:

(ix) $i = 0, \dots, m-1, j = m, \dots, 2m-1$ (continued from above) :

$$\begin{aligned} &\stackrel{H_0}{=} \pi(h) f_{j-m} f_{\min\{i,j-m\}} - \pi\pi(h) f_i f_{j-m}^2 \\ &\quad + \underbrace{\mathbb{E}[O_t^2 O_{t+h}] f_{j-m} f_{\min\{i,j-m\}} + \mathbb{E}[O_{t+h} O_t O_{t-h}] f_i f_{j-m}^2 - 2\pi\pi(h) f_i f_{j-m}^2}_{k=h} \\ &\quad + f_i f_{j-m}^2 \mathbb{E}[O_t^2 O_{t-h}] - f_i f_{j-m}^2 \mathbb{E}[O_t^2 O_{t-h}] \\ &\quad + \sum_{\substack{k=1 \\ k \neq h}}^{\infty} [\mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h}] + \mathbb{E}[O_{t+k} O_t O_{t-h}] - 2\pi\pi(h)] f_i f_{j-m}^2 \\ &= 2\pi(h) f_{j-m} f_{\min\{i,j-m\}} - \pi\pi(h) f_i f_{j-m}^2 - \pi(h) f_i f_{j-m}^2 \\ &\quad + (1 - \pi)\pi(h) f_i f_{j-m}^2 - (1 - \pi)\pi(h) f_i f_{j-m}^2 \\ &\quad + f_i f_{j-m}^2 \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} [\mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h}] + \mathbb{E}[O_{t+k} O_t O_{t-h}] - 2\pi\pi(h)] \\ &= 2\pi(h) (f_{j-m} f_{\min\{i,j-m\}} - f_i f_{j-m}^2) + f_i f_{j-m}^2 \sigma_{-1,-2}^{(h)} \end{aligned}$$

(x) $i, j = m, \dots, 2m-1$ (continued from above) :

$$\begin{aligned} &\stackrel{H_0}{=} \pi(h) f_{\min\{i,j\}}^2 - \pi(h)^2 f_{i-m}^2 f_{j-m}^2 + 2\mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t+h} O_{t-h}] f_i f_j f_{\min\{i,j\}} - 2\pi(h)^2 f_{i-m}^2 f_{j-m}^2 \\ &\quad + \sum_{\substack{k=1 \\ k \neq h}}^{\infty} 2f_i^2 f_j^2 [\mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t-h} O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h}] - \pi(h)^2] \\ &= \pi(h) f_{\min\{i-m,j-m\}}^2 - \pi(h)^2 f_{i-m}^2 f_{j-m}^2 + 2\mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t+h} O_{t-h}] f_{i-m} f_{j-m} f_{\min\{i-m,j-m\}} \\ &\quad - 2f_{i-m}^2 f_{j-m}^2 \mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t+h} O_{t-h}] + \pi(h) f_{i-m}^2 f_{j-m}^2 - \pi(h) f_{i-m}^2 f_{j-m}^2 + \\ &\quad + 2f_{i-m}^2 f_{j-m}^2 \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} [\mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t-h} O_{t+k} O_{t+k-h}] - \pi(h)^2] \\ &= \pi(h) (f_{\min\{i-m,j-m\}}^2 - f_{i-m}^2 f_{j-m}^2) + 2\pi(h, 2h) f_{i-m} f_{j-m} (f_{\min\{i-m,j-m\}} - f_{i-m} f_{j-m}) \\ &\quad + f_{i-m}^2 f_{j-m}^2 \sigma_{-2,-2}^{(h)}, \end{aligned}$$

where $\pi(h, 2h) := \mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t+h} O_{t-h}]$. Substituting all elements of $\Sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^{(h)*}}$ into $\Sigma_{\mathbf{f}^{(h)*}} = \mathbf{G} \Sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^{(h)*}} \mathbf{G}^\top$ and carrying out the matrix multiplication under H_0 , the elements $\sigma_{i,j}^{(h)*}$ simplify to (see Appendix A.2)::

(i) $i, j = 0, \dots, m-1$:

$$\sigma_{i,j}^{(h)*} \stackrel{H_0}{=} \frac{1}{\pi} (f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j)$$

(ii) $i = 0, \dots, m-1, j = m, \dots, 2m-1$ ($j' = j - m$) :

$$\sigma_{i,j}^{(h)*} \stackrel{H_0}{=} \frac{2}{\pi} f_{j'} (f_{\min\{i,j'\}} - f_i f_{j'}) = 2 f_{j'} \sigma_{i,j'}^{(h)*}$$

(iii) $i, j = m, \dots, 2m-1$ ($i' = i - m, j' = j - m$) :

$$\sigma_{i,j}^{(h)*} \stackrel{H_0}{=} \frac{1}{\pi(h)^2} (f_{\min\{i',j'\}} - f_{i'} f_{j'}) \left(\pi(h) (f_{\min\{i',j'\}} - f_{i'} f_{j'}) + 2\pi(h, 2h) f_{i'} f_{j'} \right)$$

Applying the delta method to $\kappa_{\text{ord}} = A/B$, where $A = \sum_{j=0}^{m-1} (f_{jj}(h) - f_j^2)$ and $B = \sum_{j=0}^{m-1} f_j(1 - f_j)$, the relevant Jacobian is

$$\mathbf{D}_\kappa := (d_{1,0}, \dots, d_{1,m-1}, d_{2,0}, \dots, d_{2,m-1}),$$

where for $i = 0, \dots, m-1$:

$$(i) \ d_{1,i} = \frac{\partial \kappa_{\text{ord}}}{\partial f_i} = \frac{-2f_i}{B} - \frac{(1 - 2f_i)A}{B^2},$$

$$(ii) \ d_{2,i} = \frac{\partial \kappa_{\text{ord}}}{\partial f_{ii}(h)} = \frac{1}{B}.$$

Plugging the derivatives and the elements of $\Sigma_{\mathbf{f}^{(h)*}}$ into the delta method formula and evaluating under H_0 yields (see Appendix A.3 for the detailed calculation)

$$\sigma_\kappa^2 = \mathbf{D}_\kappa \Sigma_{\mathbf{f}^{(h)*}} \mathbf{D}_\kappa^\top = \frac{\frac{1}{\pi(h)} \sum_{i,j=0}^{m-1} (f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) \left(f_{\min\{i,j\}} + \left(1 + \frac{2\pi(h, 2h)}{\pi(h)} - \frac{4\pi(h)}{\pi} \right) f_i f_j \right)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1 - f_k) \right)^2}.$$

Building on this, we now investigate the finite-sample bias by means of a second-order Taylor expansion. Since the linear term $\mathbf{D}_\kappa(\hat{\mathbf{f}}^{(h)*} - \boldsymbol{\mu}^{(h)*})$ has expectation of order $o(n^{-1})$, it does not contribute to the leading bias term, and the $O(n^{-1})$ bias reduces by lemma 2.4 to

$$\text{Bias}(\hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}) = \frac{1}{2} \text{tr}(\mathbf{H}_\kappa \Sigma_{\mathbf{f}^{(h)*}}) + o(n^{-1}).$$

The elements of the Hessian $\mathbf{H}_\kappa$ are given by

$$\frac{\partial d_{1,i}}{\partial f_j} = \begin{cases} 2 \left(\frac{2f_i - 4f_i^2}{B^2} - \frac{1}{B} \right) & \text{if } i = j, \\ 2 \frac{f_i + f_j - 4f_i f_j}{B^2} & \text{if } i \neq j, \end{cases}$$

$$\frac{\partial d_{1,i}}{\partial f_{jj}(h)} = \frac{-(1 - 2f_i)}{B^2}, \quad \frac{\partial d_{2,i}}{\partial f_j} = \frac{-(1 - 2f_j)}{B^2}, \quad \frac{\partial d_{2,i}}{\partial f_{jj}(h)} = 0,$$

with detailed derivations given in Appendix A.4. Evaluating $\frac{1}{2} \text{tr}(\mathbf{H}_\kappa \Sigma_{\mathbf{f}^{(h)*}})$ under H_0 , using $\sigma_{i,m+l}^{(h)*} = 2f_l \sigma_{i,l}^{(h)*}$ from case (ii) of $\Sigma_{\mathbf{f}^{(h)*}}$ and symmetry $\sigma_{i,l}^{(h)*} = \sigma_{l,i}^{(h)*}$, yields

$$\text{Bias}(\hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}) \stackrel{H_0}{=} -\frac{1}{\pi}.$$

The detailed calculation is carried out in Appendix A.5. The results are summarized in the following theorem.

Theorem 3.12 (Asymptotic distribution and bias of $\hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}(h)$). *Let the assumptions of theorem 3.6 hold and denote*

$$\pi(h_1, \dots, h_r) := \mathbb{E}[O_0 \cdot O_{h_1} \cdots O_{h_r}].$$

Then, under the null hypothesis H_0 that (X_t) is i.i.d., the following hold as $n \rightarrow \infty$:

1. **Asymptotic normality.** The estimator $\hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}(h)$ satisfies

$$\sqrt{n} \hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}(h) \xrightarrow{d} \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma_\kappa^2),$$

where

$$\sigma_\kappa^2 = \frac{\frac{1}{\pi(h)} \sum_{i,j=0}^{m-1} (f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) \left(f_{\min\{i,j\}} + \left(1 + \frac{2\pi(h, 2h)}{\pi(h)} - \frac{4\pi(h)}{\pi} \right) f_i f_j \right)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k (1 - f_k) \right)^2}.$$

2. **Finite-sample bias.** The approximate bias of $n\hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}(h)$ under H_0 is

$$\text{Bias}(n\hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}(h)) \approx -\frac{1}{\pi},$$

so that the bias-corrected estimator is

$$\hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}^{\text{bc}}(h) := \hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}(h) + \frac{1}{n\pi}.$$

3.6.3. Consistency under H_A

Under the alternative hypothesis H_A , the process (X_t) is not i.i.d., so that there exists at least one lag $h \geq 1$ with $\kappa_{\text{ord}}(h) \neq 0$.

The estimator $\hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}(h)$ is a continuous function of the empirical frequencies $\hat{f}_i^*$ and $\hat{f}_{ii}^*(h)$. Since these are consistent estimators of f_i and $f_{ii}(h)$ (see theorem 3.6 and ??), the continuous mapping theorem (see, e.g., Kallenberg, 2021, Theorem 3.27) implies

$$\hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}(h) \xrightarrow{p} \kappa_{\text{ord}}(h) \neq 0.$$

It follows that

$$\sqrt{n} \hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}(h) \xrightarrow{p} \infty,$$

since $\hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}(h)$ converges to a nonzero constant.

Therefore, the test statistic diverges under H_A , implying that the rejection probability converges to one. This establishes the consistency of the test.

4. Simulation Study

The theoretical results derived in the preceding chapters characterize the asymptotic behavior of the proposed estimators, but leave open the question of how well these approximations perform in finite samples. In particular, the bias corrections derived for the IOV estimator (Corollary 3.10) and for $\hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}(h)$ (Theorem 3.12) are asymptotic results, and it is not a priori clear at what sample sizes they provide reliable guidance. This chapter therefore complements the theoretical analysis with a Monte Carlo simulation study, pursuing three goals: first, to assess the finite-sample accuracy of the asymptotic bias formulas; second, to investigate the rate of convergence of the estimators to their asymptotic normal distributions; and third, to examine the sensitivity of the estimators to violations of the MCAR assumption.

4.1. Setup and Design

Data generating process

All simulations are based on the BinAR(1) process as described in WeiSS (2018, Section 3.3), which serves as a flexible and tractable model for ordinal categorical time series with controllable serial dependence.

Model definition. The BinAR(1) process is parameterized by the number of categories $m \in \mathbb{N}$, the marginal probability $p \in (0, 1)$, and the thinning parameter

$$r \in \left(\max \left\{ -\frac{p}{1-p}, -\frac{1-p}{p} \right\}, 1 \right).$$

It is defined recursively by

$$X_t = B(X_{t-1}, \alpha) + B(m - X_{t-1}, \beta),$$

where $B(k, q)$ denotes a binomial random variable with parameters k and q , and where $\alpha = p(1 - r) + r$ and $\beta = p(1 - r)$. This representation has a simple interpretation: units currently in state 1 persist with probability α , while units in state 0 switch to state 1 with probability β . The parameter r controls the strength and direction of serial dependence: $r = 0$ yields an i.i.d. process, positive values imply positive autocorrelation, and negative values imply negative autocorrelation.

Distributional properties. The stationary marginal distribution of (X_t) is Binomial(m, p), so that the process is strictly stationary. In particular, the true CDF vector $\mathbf{f}$ and the index of ordinal variation (IOV) are available in closed form as

$$f_i = P(X_t \leq i) = \sum_{k=0}^i \binom{m}{k} p^k (1-p)^{m-k}, \quad i = 0, \dots, m-1,$$

$$\text{IOV} = \frac{4}{m} \sum_{i=0}^{m-1} f_i (1 - f_i).$$

The one-step-ahead transition probabilities

$$p_{i|j}(1) = P(X_t = i \mid X_{t-1} = j)$$

are given by

$$p_{i|j}(1) = \sum_{q=\max\{0, i+j-m\}}^{\min\{i, j\}} \binom{j}{q} \binom{m-j}{i-q} \alpha^q (1-\alpha)^{j-q} \beta^{i-q} (1-\beta)^{m-j+q-i}.$$

The h -step-ahead transition probabilities are obtained by replacing α and β with $\alpha_h = p(1-r^h) + r^h$ and $\beta_h = p(1-r^h)$. The joint probabilities

$$p_{ij}(h) = P(X_t = i, X_{t-h} = j)$$

are then given by

$$p_{ij}(h) = p_{i|j}(h) \cdot p_j,$$

where $p_j = P(X_t = j)$. The corresponding joint CDF components are

$$f_{ij}(h) = \sum_{k=0}^i \sum_{l=0}^j p_{kl}(h).$$

Hence, $\kappa_{\text{ord}}(h)$ is available in closed form by plugging the relevant $f_{ij}(h)$ and f_i into the formula from Definition 1.5. This makes the BinAR(1) process particularly suitable for simulation studies, as both marginal and joint quantities are analytically tractable.

Mixing properties. Finally, we verify that the BinAR(1) process satisfies the dependence assumptions required for the asymptotic theory. Since the BinAR(1) process is an ergodic Markov chain on the finite state space $\{0, \dots, m\}$ (WeiSS, 2018, p. 60), it follows that the process is ϕ -mixing with exponentially decaying coefficients, i.e. there exist constants $C > 0$ and $\rho \in (0, 1)$ such that $\phi(n) \leq C\rho^n$ for all n (WeiSS, 2018, Appendix B.2.2).

Moreover, the mixing coefficients satisfy the inequality $2\alpha(n) \leq \phi(n)$ for all n (Bradley, 2005, Eq. (1.11)). In particular, this also implies

$$\alpha(n) \leq \phi(n) \leq C\rho^n \text{ for some } C > 0, \rho \in (0, 1),$$

showing that the BinAR(1) process satisfies the mixing-assumptions of theorem 3.6.

Missingness mechanism. Missingness is introduced via the amplitude modulation framework of section 3.2. We consider three different data-generating mechanisms for the observation process (O_t) .

First, as a baseline, we assume independent missingness, where (O_t) is i.i.d. Bernoulli distributed with constant observation probability $\pi \in (0, 1]$, i.e.

$$O_t \sim \text{Bernoulli}(\pi).$$

Second, we consider a dependent missingness process, where (O_t) follows a BinAR(1) process with $m = 1$. This induces serial dependence in the observation process while preserving a binary state space.

Third, we consider observation schemes that depend on the current state of the underlying process (X_t) , corresponding to MNAR-type mechanisms. In the first variant, the observation probability increases linearly with X_t , i.e.

$$\pi_t = \pi_{\text{low}} + (\pi_{\text{high}} - \pi_{\text{low}}) \frac{X_t}{m},$$

while in the second variant it decreases linearly with X_t , i.e.

$$\pi_t = \pi_{\text{high}} - (\pi_{\text{high}} - \pi_{\text{low}}) \frac{X_t}{m}.$$

The parameters π_{low} and π_{high} define the minimum and maximum observation probabilities, respectively, and therefore determine the range in which π_t can vary. In both cases,

$$O_t \mid X_t \sim \text{Bernoulli}(\pi_t).$$

These three mechanisms allow us to study independent, serially dependent, and state-dependent missingness within a unified simulation framework.

Simulation scenarios

Two combinations of (m, p, r) are considered, chosen to represent qualitatively different settings:

- **Scenario A:** $m = 3, p = 0.20, r = 0.35$ a coarse ordinal scale with few categories, a skewed marginal distribution, and moderate serial dependence.
- **Scenario B:** $m = 10, p = 0.45, r = 0.50$ a finer ordinal scale, a near-symmetric marginal distribution, and stronger serial dependence.

The CDFs for both scenarios are shown in Figure 4.1. For each scenario, two observation probabilities are considered: $\pi = 1$ (no missingness) and $\pi = 0.75$ (25% missing at random). The time series length varies over $n \in \{50, 100, 250, 500, 1000\}$, and all results are based on $B = 1,000$ Monte Carlo replications. To study the convergence of the bias as a function of n , an additional fine grid

$$n \in \{2, 3, 5, 10, 15, 25, 37, 50, 75, 100, 150, 200, 375, 500, 750, 1000\}$$

is used for Scenario B under $\pi = 0.75$, with $B = 1,000$ replications each.

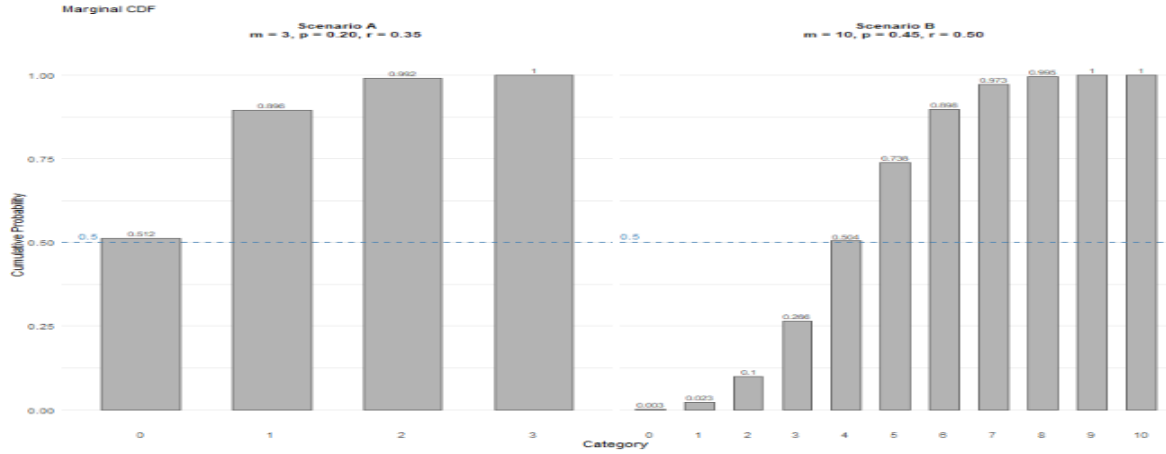


Figure 4.1.: Marginal CDFS of the two simulation scenarios.

Estimators and performance measures

In each replication, the following quantities are computed from the observed data $(O_t X_t)_{t=1}^n$: the corrected CDF estimator $\hat{f}^*$ (Definition 3.3), the IOV estimator $\widehat{\text{IOV}}$, the skewness estimator $\widehat{\text{skew}}$, and the ordinal Cohen's κ estimator $\hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}(h)$ for lags $h \in \{1, 2\}$. Performance is assessed through the following measures, averaged across replications:

- **Mean bias:** $\frac{1}{B} \sum_{b=1}^B (\hat{\theta}_b - \theta)$, where θ denotes the true parameter value.
- **n -scaled bias:** $n \cdot \frac{1}{B} \sum_{b=1}^B (\hat{\theta}_b - \theta)$, used to assess convergence to the theoretical $O(n^{-1})$ bias limit.
- **Standard deviation** across replications, compared against the asymptotic standard deviation $\sqrt{\sigma_\theta^2/n}$ derived in the theoretical chapters.

The theoretical bias limit for the IOV estimator under MCAR is given by $-\frac{4}{mn} \text{tr}(\Sigma_Z)$ (corollary 3.10), and for $\hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}(h)$ under H_0 by $-\frac{1}{n\pi}$ (theorem 3.12). These serve as benchmarks against which the simulated bias curves are compared.

A. Appendix

A.1. Derivation of the Asymptotic Covariance Matrix

$$\Sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*}$$

In this section we provide the detailed computations of the elements (ii) and (iii) of the asymptotic covariance matrix $\Sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*}$.

(ii) $j > i = -1$:

$$\begin{aligned} & \text{Cov}(O_t, O_t Z_{t,j}) + 2 \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \text{Cov}(O_t, O_{t+h} Z_{t+h,j}) \\ & \stackrel{\perp}{=} \left(\mathbb{E}[O_t^2] \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,j}] - \mathbb{E}[O_t]^2 \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,j}] \right) \\ & \quad + 2 \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \left(\mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t+h}] \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,j}] - \mathbb{E}[O_t]^2 \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,j}] \right) \\ & = (\pi - \pi^2) f_j + 2 \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} (\gamma_O(h) + \pi^2 - \pi^2) f_j \\ & = \pi(1 - \pi) f_j + 2 f_j \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \gamma_O(h) = f_j \left(\pi(1 - \pi) + 2 \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \gamma_O(h) \right) \\ & = f_j \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, -1} \end{aligned}$$

(iii) $i, j \geq 0$:

$$\begin{aligned} & \text{Cov}(O_t Z_{t,i}, O_t Z_{t,j}) + \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \left[\text{Cov}(O_t Z_{t,i}, O_{t+h} Z_{t+h,j}) + \text{Cov}(O_{t+h} Z_{t+h,i}, O_t Z_{t,j}) \right] \\ & \stackrel{\perp}{=} \left(\mathbb{E}[O_t^2] \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,i} Z_{t,j}] - \mathbb{E}[O_t]^2 \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,i}] \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,j}] \right) \\ & \quad + \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \left[\mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t+h}] \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,i} Z_{t+h,j}] - \mathbb{E}[O_t] \mathbb{E}[O_{t+h}] \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,i}] \mathbb{E}[Z_{t+h,j}] \right. \\ & \quad \left. + \mathbb{E}[O_t O_{t+h}] \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,j} Z_{t+h,i}] - \mathbb{E}[O_t] \mathbb{E}[O_{t+h}] \mathbb{E}[Z_{t,j}] \mathbb{E}[Z_{t+h,i}] \right] \\ & = \left(\pi f_{\min\{i,j\}} - \pi^2 f_i f_j \right) + \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \pi(h) (f_{ij}(h) + f_{ji}(h)) - 2\pi^2 f_i f_j \\ & \quad + 2f_i f_j \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \gamma_O(h) - 2f_i f_j \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \gamma_O(h) + f_i f_j \pi - f_i f_j \pi \\ & = f_i f_j \pi(1 - \pi) + f_i f_j \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \gamma_O(h) + \pi(f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) \\ & \quad + \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \left(\pi(h) (f_{ij}(h) + f_{ji}(h)) - 2f_i f_j (\gamma_O(h) + \pi^2) \right) \\ & = f_i f_j \sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^*; -1, -1} + \pi(f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) + \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \pi(h) (f_{ij}(h) + f_{ji}(h) - 2f_i f_j) \end{aligned}$$

A.2. Derivation of the Asymptotic Covariance Matrix

$$\Sigma_{\mathbf{f}^{(h)*}}$$

In this section, we provide the detailed derivation of the elements of the asymptotic covariance matrix $\Sigma_{\mathbf{f}^{(h)*}}$.

By the multivariate delta method, the asymptotic covariance matrix of $\sqrt{n}(\hat{\mathbf{f}}^{(h)*} - \mu)$ is given by

$$\Sigma_{\mathbf{f}^{(h)*}} = \mathbf{G} \Sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^{(h)*}} \mathbf{G}^\top.$$

Carrying out the matrix multiplication row by row yields

$$\mathbf{G} \Sigma_{\mathbf{Z}^{(h)*}} \mathbf{G}^\top = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{-f_0}{\pi} \sigma_{-1,-2}^{(h)} + \frac{1}{\pi} \sigma_{0,-2}^{(h)} & \cdots & \frac{-f_0}{\pi} \sigma_{-1,2m-1}^{(h)} + \frac{1}{\pi} \sigma_{0,2m-1}^{(h)} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \frac{-f_{m-1}}{\pi} \sigma_{-1,-2}^{(h)} + \frac{1}{\pi} \sigma_{m-1,-2}^{(h)} & \cdots & \frac{-f_{m-1}}{\pi} \sigma_{-1,2m-1}^{(h)} + \frac{1}{\pi} \sigma_{m-1,2m-1}^{(h)} \\ \frac{-f_{00}(h)}{\pi(h)} \sigma_{-2,-2}^{(h)} + \frac{1}{\pi(h)} \sigma_{m,-2}^{(h)} & \cdots & \frac{-f_{00}(h)}{\pi(h)} \sigma_{-2,2m-1}^{(h)} + \frac{1}{\pi(h)} \sigma_{m,2m-1}^{(h)} \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \frac{f_{m-1,m-1}(h)}{\pi(h)} \sigma_{-2,-2}^{(h)} + \frac{1}{\pi(h)} \sigma_{2m-1,-2}^{(h)} & \cdots & \frac{-f_{m-1,m-1}(h)}{\pi(h)} \sigma_{-2,2m-1}^{(h)} + \frac{1}{\pi(h)} \sigma_{2m-1,2m-1}^{(h)} \end{pmatrix} \mathbf{G}^\top.$$

To obtain explicit expressions for the entries $\sigma_{i,j}^{(h)*}$, we distinguish three cases depending on whether the indices correspond to marginal or bivariate components:

(i) $i, j = 0, \dots, m-1$:

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma_{i,j}^{(h)*} &= \frac{f_i f_j}{\pi^2} \sigma_{-1,-1}^{(h)} - \frac{f_j}{\pi^2} \sigma_{i,-1}^{(h)} - \frac{f_i}{\pi^2} \sigma_{-1,j}^{(h)} + \frac{1}{\pi^2} \sigma_{i,j}^{(h)} \\ &= \frac{1}{\pi} (f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) + \sum_{h=1}^{\infty} \pi(h) (f_{ij}(h) + f_{ji}(h) - 2f_i f_j) \\ &\stackrel{H_0}{=} \frac{1}{\pi} (f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) \end{aligned}$$

(ii) $i = 0, \dots, m-1, j = m, \dots, 2m-1$ ($j' = j - m$) :

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma_{i,j}^{(h)*} &= \frac{1}{\pi(h) \pi} \left(2\pi(h) f_{j'} (f_{\min\{i,j'\}} - f_i f_{j'}) + f_i f_{j'}^2 \sigma_{-1,-2}^{(h)} - f_{j'j'}(h) f_i \sigma_{-1,-2}^{(h)} \right) \\ &\stackrel{H_0}{=} \frac{2}{\pi} f_{j'} (f_{\min\{i,j'\}} - f_i f_{j'}) \end{aligned}$$

(iii) $i, j = m, \dots, 2m-1$ ($i' = i - m, j' = j - m$) :

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma_{i,j}^{(h)*} &= \frac{1}{\pi(h)^2} (f_{\min\{i',j'\}} - f_{i'} f_{j'}) \left(\pi(h) (f_{\min\{i',j'\}} - f_{i'} f_{j'}) \right. \\ &\quad \left. + 2\pi(h, 2h) f_{i'} f_{j'} \right). \end{aligned}$$

A.3. Asymptotic Variance of $\hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}(h)$

We derive the asymptotic variance $\sigma_{\kappa}^2 = \mathbf{D}_{\kappa} \Sigma_{\mathbf{f}^{(h)*}} \mathbf{D}_{\kappa}^{\top}$ under H_0 . Plugging the derivatives $d_{1;i}$ and $d_{2;i}$ and the elements of $\Sigma_{\mathbf{f}^{(h)*}}$ into the delta method formula yields

$$\begin{aligned}
& \mathbf{D}_{\kappa} \Sigma_{\mathbf{f}^{(h)*}} \mathbf{D}_{\kappa}^{\top} \\
&= \sum_{i,j=0}^{m-1} d_{1,i} d_{1,j} \sigma_{i,j}^{(h)*} + 2 \sum_{i,j=0}^{m-1} d_{1,i} d_{2,j} \sigma_{i,j+m}^{(h)*} + \sum_{i,j=0}^{m-1} d_{2,i} d_{2,j} \sigma_{i+m,j+m}^{(h)*} \\
&= \sum_{i,j=0}^{m-1} \frac{4f_i f_j}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} \sigma_{i,j}^{(h)*} + 2 \sum_{i,j=0}^{m-1} \frac{-2f_i}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} \sigma_{i,j+m}^{(h)*} \\
&\quad + \sum_{i,j=0}^{m-1} \frac{1}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} \sigma_{i+m,j+m}^{(h)*} \\
&= \frac{1}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} \sum_{i,j=0}^{m-1} \left(4f_i f_j \sigma_{i,j}^{(h)*} - 4f_i \sigma_{i,j+m}^{(h)*} + \sigma_{i+m,j+m}^{(h)*}\right) \\
&= \frac{1}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} \sum_{i,j=0}^{m-1} \left(4f_i f_j \frac{1}{\pi} (f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) - 4f_i \frac{2}{\pi} f_j (f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) \right. \\
&\quad \left. + \frac{1}{\pi(h)^2} (f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) \left[\pi(h) (f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) + 2\pi(h, 2h) f_i f_j \right] \right) \\
&= \frac{1}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} \frac{1}{\pi(h)} \sum_{i,j=0}^{m-1} \left(-4f_i f_j \frac{\pi(h)}{\pi} (f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) \right. \\
&\quad \left. + (f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j)^2 + (f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) \frac{2\pi(h, 2h)}{\pi(h)} f_i f_j \right) \\
&\quad + \frac{1}{\pi(h)} \sum_{i,j=0}^{m-1} (f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) \left(f_{\min\{i,j\}} + \left(1 + \frac{2\pi(h, 2h)}{\pi(h)} - \frac{4\pi(h)}{\pi}\right) f_i f_j \right) \\
&= \frac{\frac{1}{\pi(h)} \sum_{i,j=0}^{m-1} (f_{\min\{i,j\}} - f_i f_j) \left(f_{\min\{i,j\}} + \left(1 + \frac{2\pi(h, 2h)}{\pi(h)} - \frac{4\pi(h)}{\pi}\right) f_i f_j \right)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2}.
\end{aligned}$$

A.4. Hessian $\kappa(h)$

In this section, we derive the partial derivatives of $d_{1,i}$ with respect to f_j .

Case $i = j$

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{\partial d_{1,i}}{\partial f_i} &= \frac{\partial}{\partial f_i} \left(\frac{-2f_i}{\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)} - \frac{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} (f_{kk}(h) - f_k^2)\right)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} + \frac{2f_i \left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} (f_{kk}(h) - f_k^2)\right)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} \right) \\
&= \frac{-2 \left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right) + 2f_i(1-2f_i)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} - \frac{-2f_i \left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2 - \left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_{kk}(h) - f_k^2\right) 2\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)(1-2f_i)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^4}
\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
& + \frac{\left(2 \left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} (f_{kk}(h) - f_k^2)\right) - 4f_i f_i\right) \left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2 - 2f_i \left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_{kk}(h) - f_k^2\right) 2\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)(1-2f_i)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^4} \\
& = \frac{-2}{\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)} + \frac{2f_i(1-2f_i)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} + \frac{2f_i}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} + \frac{2f_i \left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_{kk}(h) - f_k^2\right) 2(1-2f_i)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^3} \\
& + \frac{2 \left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_{kk}(h) - f_k^2\right) - 4f_i f_i}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} - \frac{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_{kk}(h) - f_k^2\right) 2(1-2f_i)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^3} \\
& = \frac{2f_i - 4f_i^2 + 2f_i + 2f_i \kappa(h) 2(1-2f_i) - 4f_i^2 - \kappa(h) 2(1-2f_i)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} - \frac{2(1-\kappa(h))}{\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)} \\
& = \frac{4f_i - 8f_i^2 + \kappa(h)(2(3f_i - 1 - 2f_i^2))}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} - \frac{2(1-\kappa(h))}{\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)} \\
& \stackrel{H_0}{=} 2 \left(\frac{2f_i - 4f_i^2}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} - \frac{1}{\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)} \right)
\end{aligned}$$

Case $i \neq j$

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{\partial d_{1,i}}{\partial f_j} &= \frac{\partial}{\partial f_j} \left(\frac{-2f_i}{\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)} - \frac{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} (f_{kk}(h) - f_k^2)\right)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} + \frac{2f_i \left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} (f_{kk}(h) - f_k^2)\right)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} \right) \\
&= \frac{2f_i(1-2f_j)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} - \frac{-2f_j \left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2 - \left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_{kk}(h) - f_k^2\right) 2\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)(1-2f_j)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^4} \\
&+ 2f_i \frac{-2f_j \left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2 - \left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} (f_{kk}(h) - f_k^2)\right) 2\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)(1-2f_j)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^4} \\
&= \frac{2f_i(1-2f_j)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} + \frac{2f_j}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} + \frac{(1-2f_j)\kappa(h)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} \\
&- \frac{4f_i f_j}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} - \frac{4f_i(1-2f_j)\kappa(h)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} \\
&= \frac{2f_i - 4f_i f_j + 2f_j + \kappa(h) - 4f_i - 2f_j \kappa(h) - 4f_i f_j + 8f_i f_j \kappa(h)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} \\
&\stackrel{H_0}{=} 2 \frac{f_i + f_j - 4f_i f_j}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2}
\end{aligned}$$

A.5. Bias $\kappa(h)$

Using the Hessian elements derived above and the elements of $\Sigma_{f^{(h)*}}$ from section 3.6.2, the diagonal elements of $H_\kappa \Sigma_{f^{(h)*}}$ are given by

(i) $i = 0, \dots, m-1$:

$$\left[H_\kappa \Sigma_{f^{(h)*}} \right]_{ii} = 2 \left(-\frac{1}{B} \sigma_{i,i}^{(h)*} + \sum_{l=0}^{m-1} \frac{f_i + f_l - 4f_i f_l}{B^2} \sigma_{l,i}^{(h)*} \right) + \sum_{l=m}^{2m-1} \frac{-(1-2f_i)}{B^2} \sigma_{l,i}^{(h)*}$$

(ii) $i = m, \dots, 2m-1$ ($i' = i - m$) :

$$\left[H_\kappa \Sigma_{f^{(h)*}} \right]_{ii} = \sum_{l=0}^{m-1} \frac{-(1-2f_l)}{B^2} \sigma_{l,i'}^{(h)*}$$

Summing over all diagonal elements and substituting $\sigma_{i,m+l}^{(h)*} = 2f_l\sigma_{i,l}^{(h)*}$ from case **(ii)** of $\Sigma_{f^{(h)*}}$ and using symmetry $\sigma_{i,l}^{(h)*} = \sigma_{l,i}^{(h)*}$:

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{Bias}(\hat{\kappa}_{\text{ord}}) &= \frac{1}{2} \text{tr}(\mathbf{H}_{\kappa} \Sigma_{f^{(h)*}}) = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i=0}^{2m-1} [\mathbf{H}_{\kappa} \Sigma_{f^{(h)*}}]_{ii} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i=0}^{m-1} \left[2 \left(-\frac{1}{\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)} \sigma_{i,i}^{(h)*} + \sum_{l=0}^{m-1} \frac{f_i + f_l - 4f_i f_l}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} \sigma_{l,i}^{(h)*} \right) \right. \\
&\quad \left. + \sum_{l=m}^{2m-1} \frac{-(1-2f_i)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} \sigma_{l,i}^{(h)*} \right] + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i=m}^{2m-1} \left[\sum_{l=0}^{m-1} \frac{-(1-2f_i)}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} \sigma_{i,l}^{(h)*} \right] \\
&= -\frac{\sum_{i=0}^{m-1} \sigma_{ii}^{(h*)}}{\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)} + \frac{\sum_{i,l=0}^{m-1} (f_i + f_l - 4f_i f_l) \sigma_{l,i}^{(h)*}}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} - \frac{\sum_{i,l=0}^{m-1} (1-2f_i) \sigma_{i,m+l}^{(h)*}}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} \\
&= -\frac{\frac{1}{\pi} \sum_{i=0}^{m-1} (f_i - f_i^2)}{\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)} + \frac{\sum_{i,l=0}^{m-1} (f_i + f_l - 4f_i f_l) \sigma_{l,i}^{(h)*} - \sum_{i,l=0}^{m-1} (1-2f_i) 2f_l \sigma_{l,i}^{(h)*}}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} \\
&= -\frac{1}{\pi} + \frac{\sum_{i,l=0}^{m-1} (f_i + f_l - 4f_i f_l - 2f_l + 4f_j f_l) \sigma_{l,i}^{(h)*}}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} = -\frac{1}{\pi} + \frac{\overbrace{\sum_{i,l=0}^{m-1} (f_i - f_l) \sigma_{l,i}^{(h)*}}^{=0}}{\left(\sum_{k=0}^{m-1} f_k(1-f_k)\right)^2} \\
&= -\frac{1}{\pi}
\end{aligned}$$

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